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# COA DECISION BRIEF

## CJEX 2026

DTG : 131415L MAY26



# AIM OF THE BRIEFING (LDR)



## **The purpose of the COA Decision Brief is to:**

- Present the developed COAs and the JOPG recommendations
- Receive Commander's COA decision
- Receive Commander's Direction and Guidance



# OUTLINE (LDR)



| # | WHAT                                          | WHO | TIME |
|---|-----------------------------------------------|-----|------|
| 1 | Political and SACEUR Decision and Guidance    | LDR | 1    |
| 2 | Commander's OPG Decision and Guidance         | LDR | 1    |
| 3 | Opposing Courses of Actions                   | J2  | 5    |
| 4 | OPG Highlights & Situation Analysis (update)  | J5  | 3-5  |
| 5 | Own Forces Courses of Actions                 | J5  | 12   |
| 6 | Analysis and Comparison of Courses of Actions | J5  | 5-8  |
| 7 | Conclusion                                    | LDR | 2    |
| 8 | Commander's Decision and Guidance             | LDR | 1    |



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# OPERATIONAL MISSION (LDR)



*When authorized by SACEUR, COMWAFOR will assume OPCON of deployed NATO forces, conduct operations in accordance with UNSCR 2198 to deter Liberia expansionistic ambitions and if necessary, assist Sierra Leone in maintaining national security by preventing any external aggression; assist Sierra Leone in establishing human security by disrupting any AFRC/RUF operation; take control of the diamond mining areas; take control of the border areas to Liberia; contribute to the implementation of DDR, provide freedom of movement for UN humanitarian aid; in order to contribute to the restoration of peace and security in the Sierra Leone region.*



# POLITICAL AND SACEUR D&G (LDR)

## Highlights



### Political Direction and Guidance – New/Additional

- No change

### SACEUR Direction and Guidance – New/Additional

- Nations willing to provide forces according to serial 12.
- NATO's formalizing of SL formal invitation will cover the reaction against a potential aggression by Liberia.
- **SACEUR holds forces at strategic level IOT cope with a potential major aggression by Liberia. NTM is still under discussion. JFCNP proposal is requested.**



# CDR'S D&G (LDR) COA DEVELOPMENT



- Deploy rapidly and visibly credible forces
- Dominate information domain and influence other actors
- Ensure and maintain unimpeded access to the region by air and sea
- Create rapidly a secure base (SPOD, APOD & LOC) IOT project power to establish FoM for own and friendly forces as well as HA organizations
- Ensure robust force protection IOT limit friendly casualties
- Create the conditions to bring the peace agreement parties back to the negotiation table, using KLE, but BPT use force
- Be ready at all times to counter Liberian activities in SL
- Balance speed of deployment with risk to the force
- Balance a non-aggressive posture with the need for deterrence
- Establish and maintain early and close liaison with HN and local UN authorities
- Conduct the operations with a comprehensive mindset
- Maintain at all times a credible operational reserve force
- Develop two distinct COAs: population-centric and threat-centric
- Ensure permanent coordination with the non-military DIME instruments



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# REVIEW OF SITUATION (J2)

## Most Likely COA



### MOST LIKELY COA



### Purpose and Objectives

Take political control of SIERRA LEONE through a slow-tempo sustained insurgency campaign supplemented with a dry-season attack that protects the AFRC/RUF strategic CoG (diamond-funded armed wing under Sankoh) and denies GoSL the capacity to project force outside FREETOWN.

LIBERIA supports this effort, with weapons, funding and grey zone activities, without actual intervention by own troops.

### Actions (Time, Space, Forces)

TIME: Continuous nationwide insurgency supplemented with 3-stage dry-season campaign (Nov 26–Apr 27).

Phase 1 Posture (D-7→D+0) — concentrate forces

Phase 2 Engage (D+0→D+30) — defend DCs, expand disruption, encroach BONTHE/SULIMA.

Phase 3 Decide (D+30→D+60) — sustain interdiction, control coast, political pressure on FT.

SPACE: Centre-of-mass = Eastern diamond belt (KAILAHUN/KENEMA/PUJEHUN). LBR border salient = sustainment bridge. KENEMA-BO-FREETOWN axis = disruption corridor. Southern coast (BONTHE-SULIMA) = lateral effort.

FORCES: ~4–6,000 RUF/AFRC fighters across Eastern, Central, Southern, Western brigades; LBR sponsor enablers (logistics, SF advisors); AFRC sleeper networks inside FREETOWN.

### Conclusions

- ML CoA : dry-season slow tempo, low-signature attacks, continuous insurgency, terror and propaganda effort.
- Protection and sustainment of the mines is AFRC/RUF most important effort.
- LIBERIA will support with weapons, funding, cyber, space-ISR and grey zone activities, up to and including harrassment by naval and air units, without sending actual troops into SL territory





# REVIEW OF SITUATION (J2)



## Most Dangerous COA

### MOST DANGEROUS COA



### Purpose and Objectives

AFRC/RUF takes political control of SIERRA LEONE rapidly, before WAFOR establishes credible joint posture, IOT to maintain control over diamond mines.

LBR OCCUPY eastern SL and actively support RUF/AFRC to instore LBR influence on SL in order to achieve regional dominance

### Actions (Time, Space, Forces)

Forces: AFRC/RUF will employ coordinated attacks on SL main cities, including FREETOWN, LUNGI, and West Coast.

LBR will deploy military forces in SL in direct support of RUF/AFRC.

Time: This scenario is a short-term approach reaching ASAP to overturn the SL control in to rebels hands.

Phase 1 : CONSOLIDATE

Phase 2 : OFFENSIVE

Phase 3 : TAKE CONTROL

Space: the East part still paramount for diamond control but the main accesses from east to FREETOWN will be targeted

### Conclusions

**ARFC/RUF takes political control over SL.**

**LBR uses direct approach justified by the protection of SHERBRO and MENDE**



# REVIEW OF SITUATION (J2)



## From MLCOA to MDCOA: escalation trigger points

WAFOR errors  
undermines narrative.

WAFOR shifts local balance  
of power

WAFOR tackles  
diamond economy

WAFOR downgrades  
LIBERIA's strategic  
levers

WAFOR breaks proxy  
logic





# OUTLINE



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# COMMANDER'S OPG HIGHLIGHTS (J5)

## Own Operational Design 2(9)

### Initial Intent



#### Purpose

Enable legitimate Government control and regional stability

#### Method

Rapidly establish access through APOD/SPOD and LOCs to enable FoM and operations

Two distinct pathways:

- Population-centric – legitimacy, dialogue and governance
  - Security-centric – speed, control and decisive force
- Integrate STRATCOM/InfoOps to shape the environment
- Disrupt AFRC/RUF sustenance (diamond economy)
- Deter Liberian interference

#### Priorities

FoM • Population protection • Force Protection • Diamonds • Deterrence • Transition

#### End State

Secure environment established • Government authority restored • AFRC/RUF unable to operate or sustain • Conditions set for DDR/SSR and transition





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# OWN FORCES COURSES OF ACTIONS (J5)

## Distinct Approaches – Unified Outcomes



### COA 1- CIVIC SHIELD

- Population centric
- Focus on training and enabling
- Improving infrastructure
- Deterrence by presence
- Winning trust, restoring stability, enabling Sierra Leone

### COA 2 – CARBON CRUSH

- Threat centric
- Early Occupation of SL Economic COG
- Improving Security
- Deterrence by action
- Securing Sierra Leone to Secure sovereignty

***Operational Commonalities***  
***DEPLOYMENT, JLSG, MEDICAL PLAN, FOM Concept***

***Stability through partnership , security and the enablement SIERRA LEONE for an independent sovereign prosperous future.***



# Rules of Engagement – Strategic Framework



**This framework establishes the operational boundaries within which WAFOR forces will act.  
ROE must simultaneously enable decisive action against hostile actors — AFRC and RUF**

**Commander's Intent:** *ROE must enable decisive action against hostile actors while preserving legitimacy, protecting civilians and preventing unnecessary regional escalation.*

## Mission Accomplishment

- Freedom of Movement throughout JOA
- Defeat AFRC / RUF armed elements
- Deterrence of Liberian interference
- Protection of critical infrastructure
- Border security along eastern flank



## Legitimacy & Restraint

- Civilian protection at all times
- Preservation of humanitarian access
- Proportionality in all use of force
- Host Nation consent and coordination
- Full compliance with international law



# WAFOR Combatant ROE Card



In accordance with UNSCR 2198, you the WAFOR Combatant is authorised to use escalating and proportional force in the following circumstance.

**Self-Defence**

**Protection of Civilians**

**Protection of NATO/UN/ECOMOG Forces**

**FOM Operations**

**Counter-AFRC/RUF Operations**

**Maritime Security Operations**

**Border Security Operations**

**Deterrence Operations**

## WAFOR SOLDIER CARD

### 1. VERBAL WARNING

Oral challenge, interpreter supported where possible.

### 2. VISUAL WARNING

Light, signal, pyrotechnic, to indicate intent.

### 3. NON-LETHAL MEASURES

Physical restraint, baton.

### 4. WARNING SHOTS

Aimed away from personnel. Final warning before direct fire

### 5. DIRECTED FIRE

Targeted suppressive fire. PiD Required.

### 6. DEADLY FORCE

Shoot to kill. Last resort, PID & Proportionality required.



# Provisional Component Tasks



## LCC

Deploy  
Train  
Occupy  
Secure  
Control  
Handover

## SOCC

Conduct SR  
BPT Conduct DA  
Enable local resistance  
Conduct KLE

## ACC

Deploy  
Support  
Strike

## JLSG

Deploy  
Supply  
Sustain  
Reconstruct

## MCC

Deploy  
Secure SLOC  
Escort  
Interdict  
Strike





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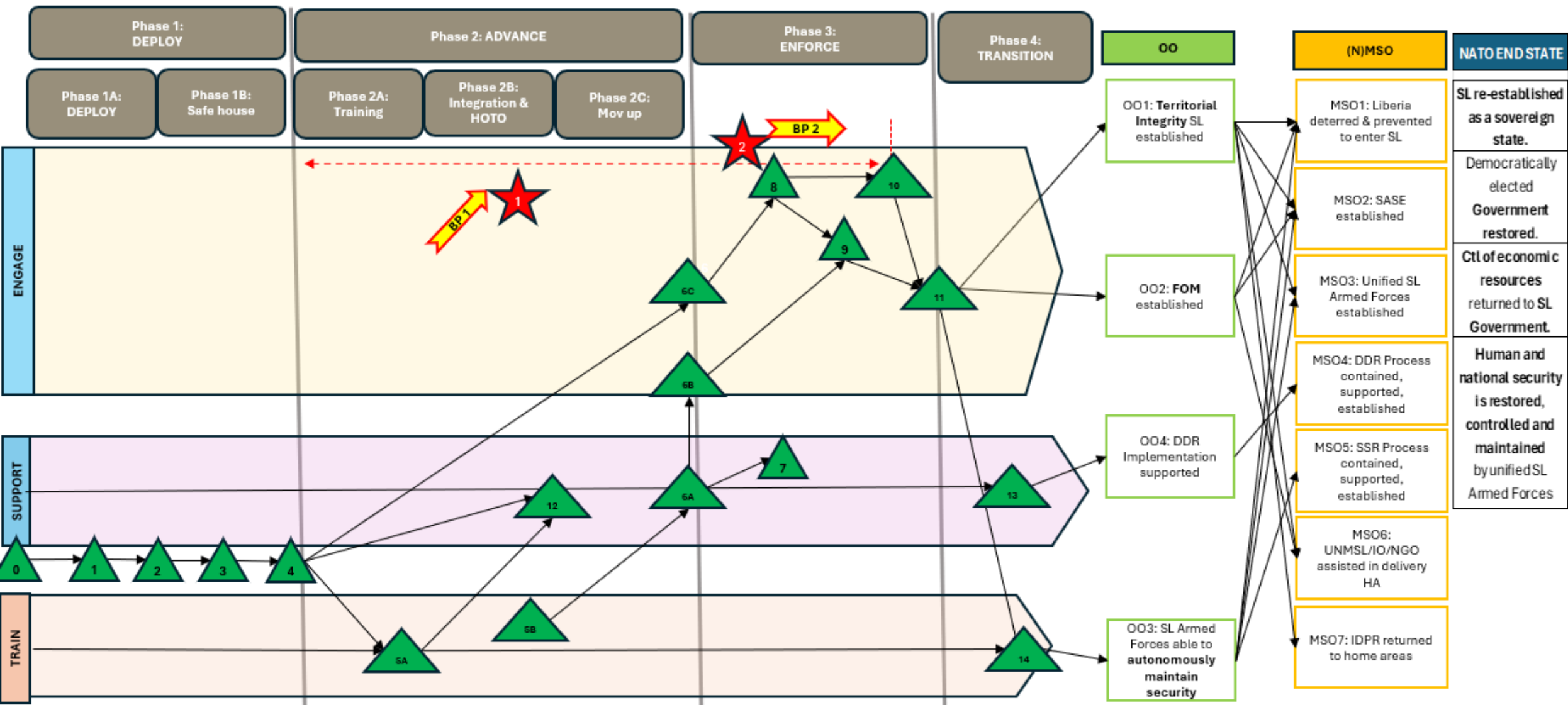


Joint Force West Africa **protects the civilian population of Sierra Leone, defeats armed groups threatening the stability of the state, and builds the capacity of the Sierra Leonean national army** to maintain security independently, in order to restore a secure and stable environment conducive to the re-establishment of legitimate governance and long-term peace.

Joint Force West Africa executes a **phased campaign** across 4 sequential phases. The joint force enters Sierra Leone through Freetown, secures the capital, advances to isolate armed groups from their sources of revenue and reinforcement, defeats remaining resistance, and transitions security responsibility to the Sierra Leonean national army before redeploying

Throughout all phases, the **influence and information effort** (POTF) runs concurrently to maintain population support, undermine armed group cohesion, and sustain international legitimacy.





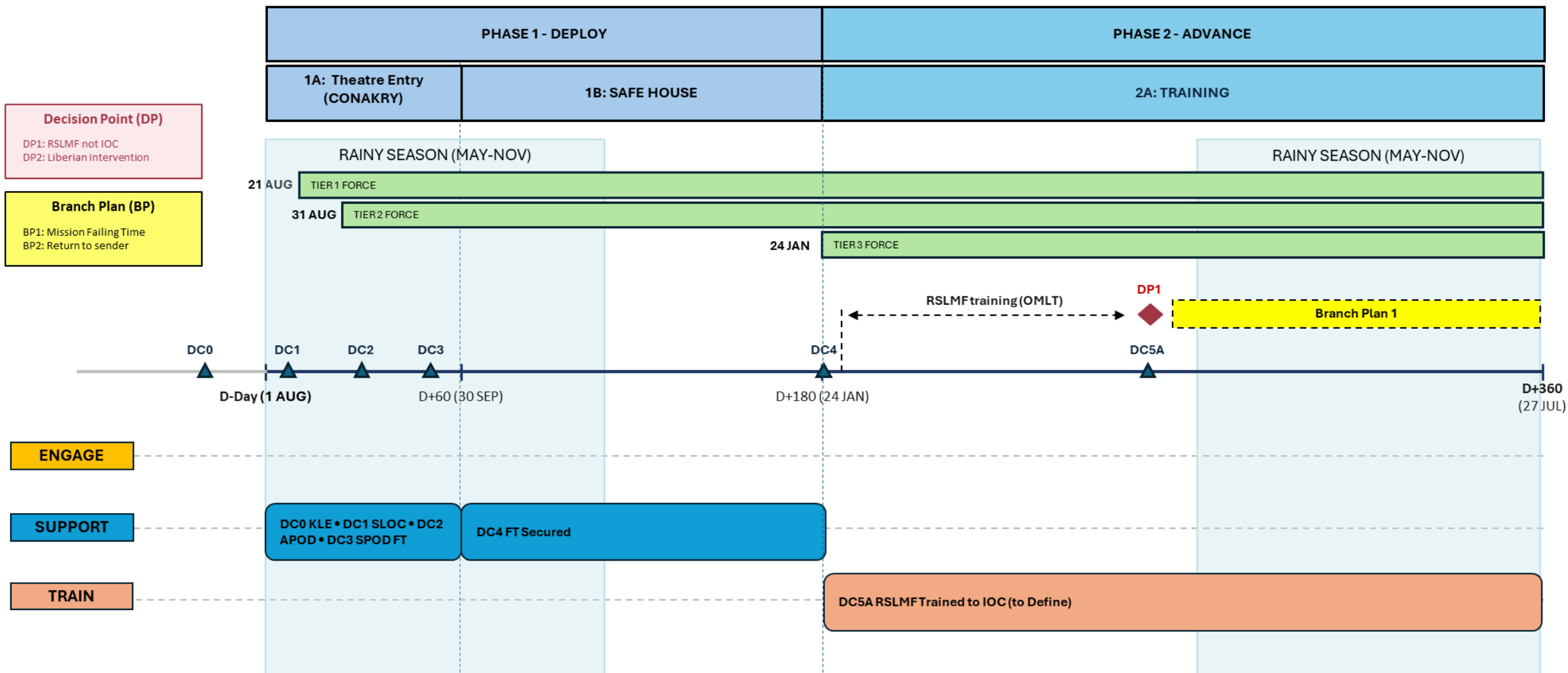
| Decisive Conditions (DC) |                                                                                           |    |                                                  |    |                                                                     |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----|--------------------------------------------------|----|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 0                        | KLE initial conditions established                                                        |    |                                                  | 9  | Diamond Mining Area's secured                                       |
| 1                        | SLOC Secured                                                                              | 5C | Combat Capable RSLMF achieved                    | 10 | Liberian Forces long term Deterred                                  |
| 2                        | APOD Lungi Secured                                                                        | 6A | LOC to IDP/Refugee Camp Secured (integration)    | 11 | RUF/AFRC Neutralized/Destroyed                                      |
| 3                        | SPOD Freetown Secured                                                                     | 6B | LOC to Diamond Area's Camp secured (integration) | 12 | DDR Compounds/population centre established iccw GOV SL in Freetown |
| 4                        | Freetown secured & stabilized                                                             | 6C | LOC to Border Liberia secured                    | 13 | DDR Compounds/population centre established iccw GOV SL in SL       |
| 5A                       | RSLMF Trained to IOC                                                                      | 7  | IDP/Refugee Camp Secured                         | 14 | RSLMF FOC and able to secure                                        |
|                          | Trained and equipped to defend FREETOWN and preparing to integrate in (International Org) | 8  | Liberian border area Secured                     |    |                                                                     |

| Decision Point (DP) |                       |
|---------------------|-----------------------|
| 1                   | RSLMF not IOC         |
| 2                   | Liberian intervention |

| Branch Plan (BP) |                  |
|------------------|------------------|
| 1                | Solo slim        |
| 2                | Return to sender |

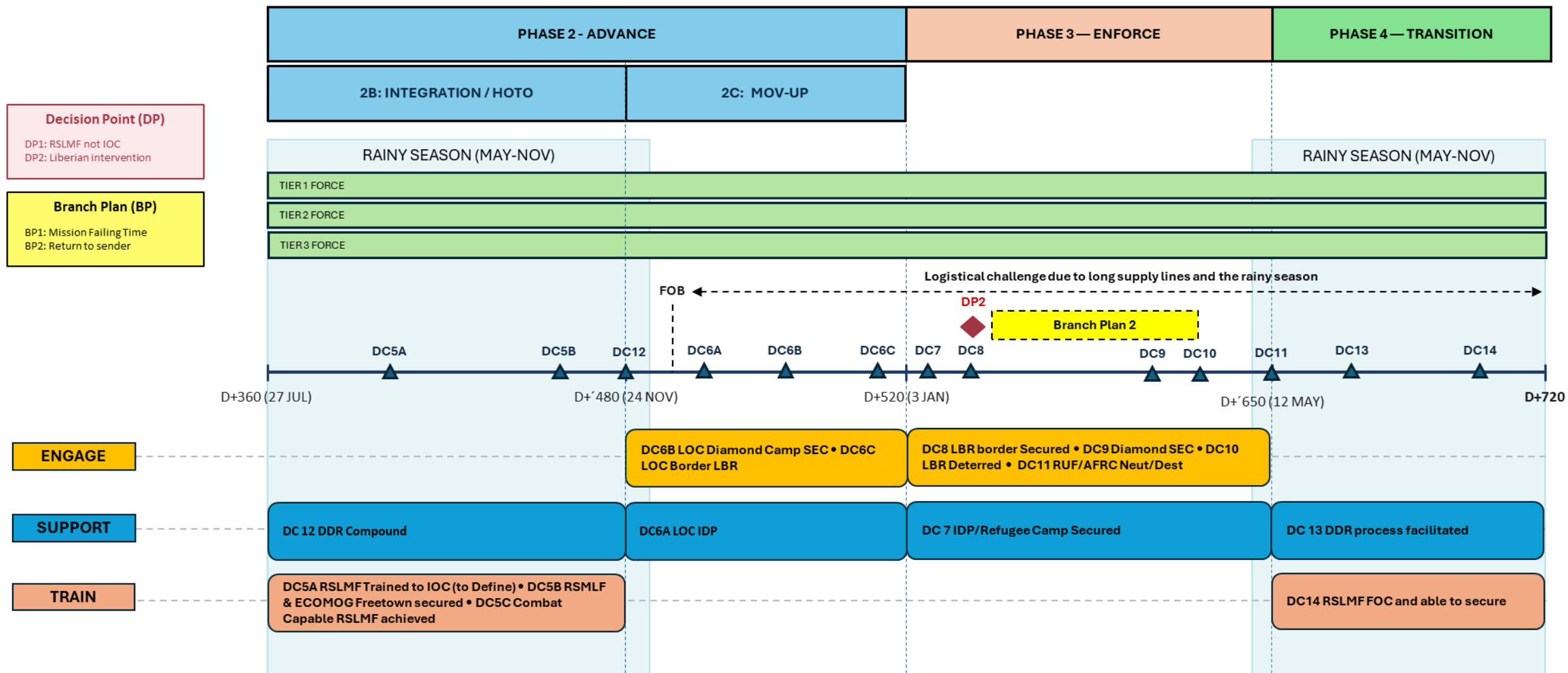


## CoA 1 - 24-Month Operational Timeline





## CoA 1 - 24-Month Operational Timeline







## PH1- DEPLOY

## PH2 - ADVANCE

## PH1A - DEPLOY

Deploy &  
build UpDC to Achieve  
DC 1A, DC, 1B DC  
2, DC 3

## PH 1B- SAFE HOUSE

Freetown  
(FT) Safe  
HubDC to Achieve  
DC 4

## PH2A - TRAINING

RSLMF  
Trained IOCDC to Achieve  
DC 5A

## PH2B - HOTO

RSLMF &  
ECOMOG  
secured FTDC to Achieve  
DC 5B, DC 5C, DC  
12

## PH2C – MOV UP

Prio Land LOC  
SecuredDC to Achieve  
DC 6A, DC 6 B, DC  
6C,

Start  
ACTPRED  
D-Day

End  
DC 3 Achieved

Start  
DC 3 Achieved

End  
DC 4 Achieved

Start  
DC 4 Achieved

End  
DC 5A Achieved

Start  
DC 5A Achieved

End  
DC 5B Achieved

Start  
DC 5B Achieved

End  
DC 6A-6C Achieved



## PH3 - ENFORCE

Restored Terr. Integrity of SL  
Deterred Liberian Forces

DC to Achieve

DC 7, DC 8, DC 9, DC 10,  
DC 11



Start

DC 6A-6C Achieved

End

DC 11 Achieved

## PH 4 - TRANSITION

SL Gov Security forces Able to Act  
Independently  
SASE

DC to Achieve

DC 13, DC 14



Start

DC 11 Achieved

End

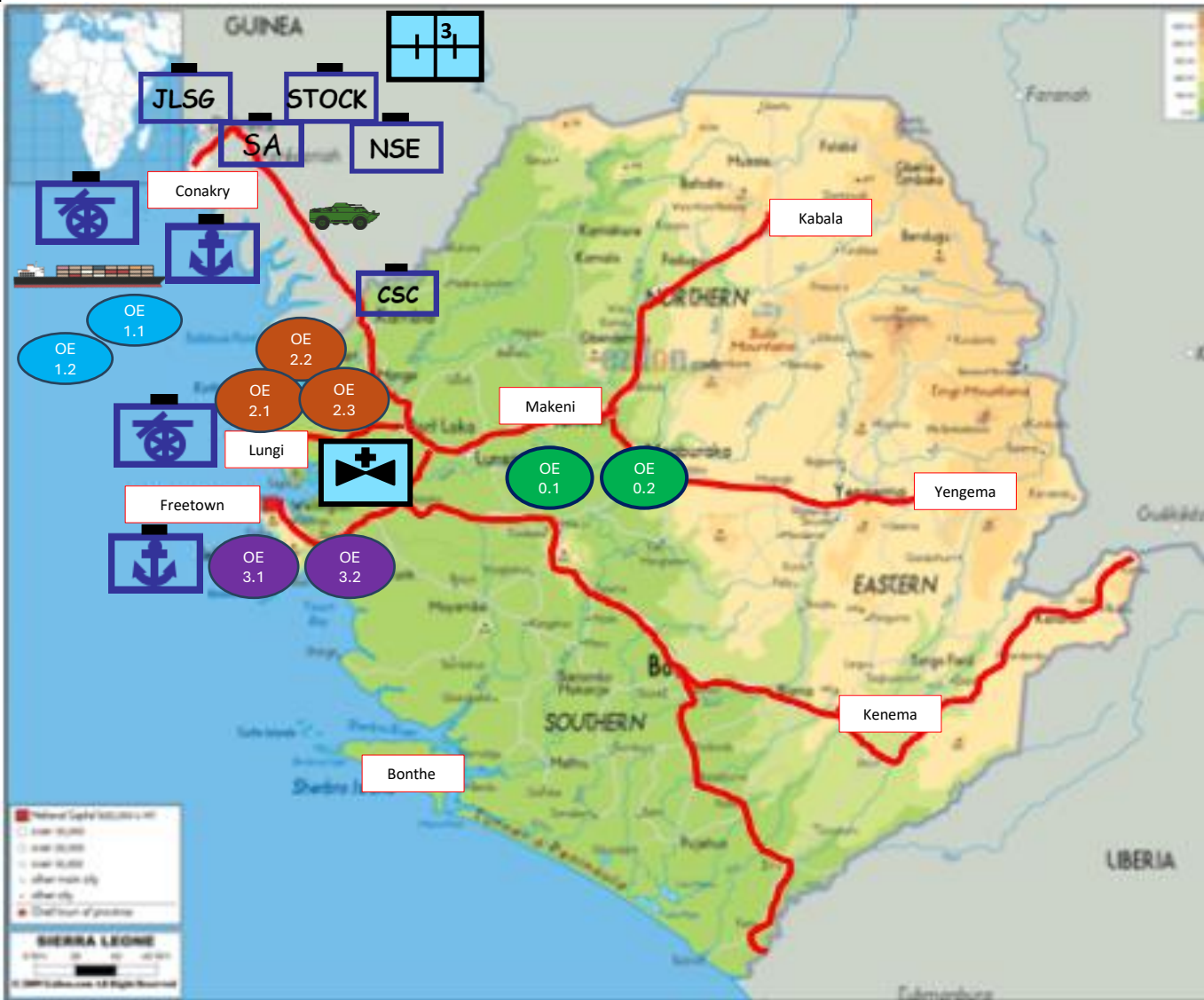
DC 14 Achieved



PHASE 1A: DEPLOY

**Purpose:** Deploy forces to JOA  
**Start:** 25 JUL (KLE as from now)  
**End:** D + 60

**Narrative:**  
“Rapid deployment of Log elements will commence immediately upon ACTPRED. Upon arrival, JLSG will start immediate organization and operationalization of SA and buildup of stocks in Conakry. Freedom of movement on sea is an absolute must. The next effort is to be put on securing the APOD and SPOD of FREETOWN ”



- 1. DC
  - a. DC0 – KLE initial conditions established
  - b. DC1 – SLOC Secured
  - c. DC2 – APOD LUNGI secured
  - d. DC3 – SPOD FREETOWN secured
- 2. OE
  - a. OE0.1 Coordinate and Inform Key Leadership
  - b. OE0.2 Understand current situation
  - c. OE1.1. Develop Maritime forces
  - d. OE1.2 Sea Control established
  - e. OE2.1. Develop Force protection around Airport LUNGI
  - f. OE2.2 Defend airport of LUNGI
  - g. OE2.3 Empower local authorities
  - h. OE3.1 Develop Harbor Protection around FREETOWN Harbor
  - i. OE3.2 Delend Harbor of FREETOWN
- 3. Joint actions
  - a. Start shaping the condition IOT allow a KLE as soon as possible. Establish SA in SL. Organise the JLSG in GUINEA (CONAKRY), establish RMP, ensure secure deployment to SL.
- 4. Component actions
  - a. JFLCC: Deploy + Link up with ECOMOG + start missions in LUNGI and FREETOWN- C-UAS (additional force requested)
  - b. JFACC : Deploy
  - c. JFMCC (Supported): Deploy and build-up SA + Patrol + Escort RoRo
  - d. C-SOCC: Locate persons of interest IOT obtain information
  - e. POTF: Prepare and disperse narrative for population SL
  - f. CYBER: Counter LIB cyberattacks
- 1. Operational Reserve: 1x Mec Infantry Bde (QRF) + 1x MSU Coy (additional capability requested)

PHASE 1B: SAFE HOUSE

**Purpose:** Create a safe haven in FREETOWN

**Start:** D + 60 days

**End:** D + 180 days

**Narrative:**

“LC will focus on FREETOWN IOT create a safe area. This will also focus the protection of civilian population IVO FREETOWN through the deterrence of attacks on civilians through protective presence and active patrolling”



**1. DC**

- a. DC0 – KLE initial conditions established
- b. DC1 – SLOC Secured
- c. DC2 – APOD LUNGI secured
- d. DC3 – SPOD FREETOWN secured
- e. DC 4 - FREETOWN Secured & Stabilized

**2. OE**

- a. OE0.1 Coordinate and Inform Key Leadership
- b. OE1.2 Sea Control established
- c. OE2.2 Defend airport of LUNGI
- d. OE2.3 Empower local authorities
- e. OE3.2 Defend Harbor of FREETOWN
- f. OE4.1 Develop Force protection capability in wider area Freetown
- g. OE4.2 Defend FREETOWN
- h. OE4.3 Secure FREETOWN
- i. OE4.4 Interdict RUF/AFRC to execute terror actions in FREETOWN
- j. OE4.5 Destabilize RUF/AFRC in FREETOWN
- k. OE4.6 Deter RUF/AFRC in FREETOWN
- l. OE4.7 Reassure and influence the local population
- m. OE4.8 Stabilize FREETOWN

**3. Joint actions**

- a. Establish SA in JOA, maintain RMP, ensure secure deployment to SL. ISR- C-UAS

**4. Component actions**

- a. JFLCC (supported): Deploy, secure and protect LOCs to FREETOWN and start actions in FREETOWN
- b. JFACC : Provide air support for all actions in SL+ ISR + Show of force
- c. JFMCC: Escort RoRo + Patrol
- d. C-SOCC: Counter-terrorist actions in FREETOWN and slow start on MSR
- e. POTF: Continue to disperse narrative for population SL - Population influenced
- f. CYBER: No change

**5. Operational Reserve:** 1x Mec Infantry Bde (QRF)



PHASE 2A: Training

Purpose: Training RSLMF

Start: D + 180 days

End: D + 360 Day

Narrative:

“WAFOR trains with RSLMF forces to give them the necessary level of operationality to secure Freetown. The aim is to promote integration and operability between both actors in Freetown so RSLMF & ECOMOG can take over security tasks in Freetown and support the DDR process withing Freetown.”



1. DC

- a. DC0 – KLE initial conditions established
- b. DC1 – SLOC Secured
- c. DC2 – APOD LUNGI secured
- d. DC3 – SPOD FREETOWN secured
- e. DC 4 - FREETOWN Secured & Stabilized
- f. DC 5A - RSLMF - Train the RSLMF to be able to execute basic protection and securing tasks in FREETOWN

2. OE

- a. OE0.1 Coordinate and Inform Key Leadership
- b. OE1.2 Sea Control established
- c. OE2.2 Defend airport of LUNGI
- d. OE2.3 Empower local authorities
- e. OE3.2 Delend Harbor of FREETOWN
- f. OE4.8 Stabilize FREETOWN
- g. OE 5A.1 Develop & support the RSLMF to be able to execute basic protection and securing tasks in FREETOWN
- h. OE5A.2 Empower RSLMF to take over protection of Freetown from NATO
- i. OE5A.3Develop RSLMF-ECOMOG integration capability

3. Joint actions

- a. Train and obtain the level of operationality that makes a relief in place by RSLMF and ECOMOG in FREETOWN possible IOT create the conditions to move to phase 2B. Train, ISR, Support Humanitarian Aid

4. Component actions

- a. JFLCC (Supported): Training of RSLMF – C-UAS
- b. JFACC: Provide air support for all actions in SL+ ISR + show of force
- c. JFMCC: Escort RoRo + Patrol
- d. C-SOCC: Counter-terrorist actions on MSR
- e. POTF: Promote RSLMF with local population + continuation to influence population
- f. CYBER: No change

5. Operational Reserve: 1x Mec Infantry Bde (QRF)

PHASE 2B: Integration & HOTO

Purpose: HOTO protection FREETOWN

Start: D + 360 days

End: D + 480 days

Narrative:

“WAFOR trains with RSLMF forces to bring them to the necessary level of operational readiness to secure Freetown. The aim is to promote integration and interoperability between RSLMF and ECOMOG in Freetown so that both actors can gradually take over security tasks and support the DDR process in Freetown.



1. DC

- a. DC0 – KLE initial conditions established
- b. DC1 – SLOC Secured
- c. DC2 – APOD LUNGI secured
- d. DC3 – SPOD FREETOWN secured
- e. DC 4 - FREETOWN Secured & Stabilized
- f. DC 5A - RSLMF Trained to IOC (trained and equipped to defend FREETOWN and preparing to integrate in International Org)
- g. DC 5B - Combat capable RSMLF achieved
- h. DC 12- DDR Compounds/population center established iccw GOV SL in FREETOWN

2. OE

- a. OE0.1 Coordinate and Inform Key Leadership
- b. OE1.2 Sea Control established
- c. OE2.2 Defend airport of LUNGI
- d. OE3.2 Delend Harbor of FREETOWN
- e. OE4.8 Stabilize FREETOWN
- f. OE5A.4 Support relief in place
- g. OE5B.1 Develop RSLMF combat capability to conduct offensive operations
- h. OE5B.2 Assess RSLMF combat readiness
- i. OE5B.3 Integrate RSLMF into combined operations with WAFOR
- j. OE5B.4 Empower RSLMF to conduct independent combat tasks
- k. OE5B.4 Relief in place
- l. OE12.1 Support SL Gov in establishing DDR compounds in Freetown
- m. OE12.2 Secure the DDR compound in FREETOWN

3. Joint actions

- a. Organise relief in place by RSLMF and ECOMOG , DDR compounds . Train, ISR, Support HA.

4. Component actions

- a. JFLCC (Supported): Training of RSLMF + relief in place + build up forces to enter the next phase , C-UAS
- b. JFACC : Provide air support for all actions in SL+ ISR
- c. JFMCC: Escort RoRo + Patrol
- d. C-SOCC: Counter-terrorist actions on MSR + Diamond mines
- e. POTF: Continuation to influence population
- f. CYBER: No change

5. Operational Reserve: 1x Mec Infantry Bde (QRF)



PHASE 2C: Mov Up

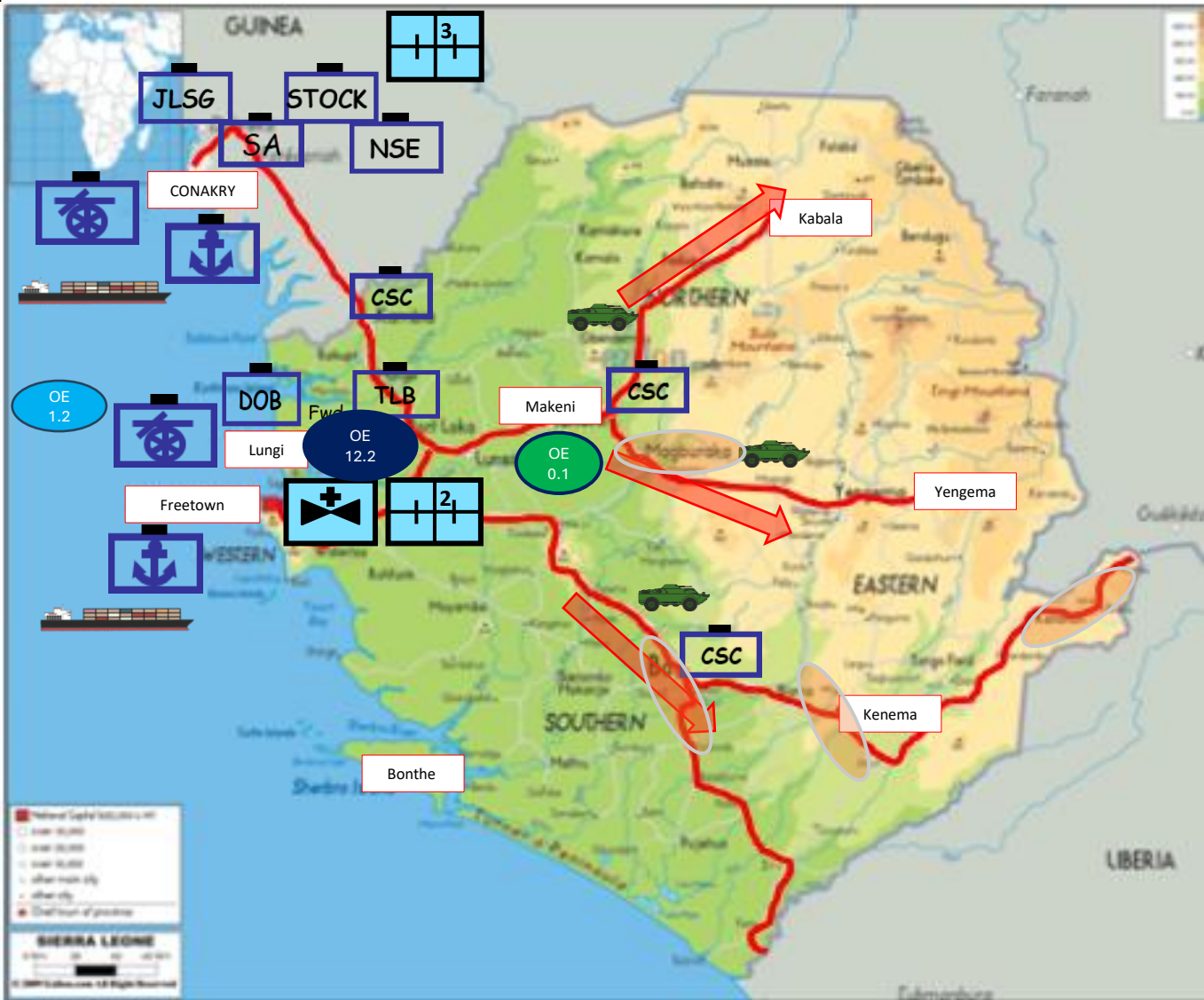
**Purpose:** Mov Up to IDP Camps and diamond mining areas

**Start:** D + 480 days

**End:** D + 520 days

**Narrative:**

“WAFOR trains, mentors, and evaluates RSLMF units to achieve combat readiness, progressively transferring lead for operations and mov up with WAFOR to IDP CAMPS and mining areas. Simultaneously, working on the main LLOC (to IDP/refugee camps, diamond mining areas, and the Liberian border. The goal is to have them cleared, patrolled, and secured) to guarantee FoM and safe passage for forces and humanitarian organizations.”



**1. DC**

- a. DC0 – KLE initial conditions established
- b. DC1 – SLOC Secured
- c. DC 5B Combat Capable achieved
- d. DC 6A LOC IDP/Refugee Camp secured
- e. DC 6B LOC Diamond Mining Areas secured
- f. DC 6C LOC Liberian Border Secured
- g. DC 12- DDR Compounds/population center established iccw GOV SL in FREETOWN

**1. OE**

- a. OE0.1 Coordinate and Inform Key Leadership
- b. OE1.2 Sea Control established
- c. OE5B.4 Relief in place
- d. OE 6A/B/C.1. Secure LLOC
- e. OE 6A/B/C.2. Protect & Control LLOC
- f. OE 6B/C.3. Secure Convoys

**2. Joint actions**

- a. Train, ISR, Support Humanitarian Aid

**3. Component actions**

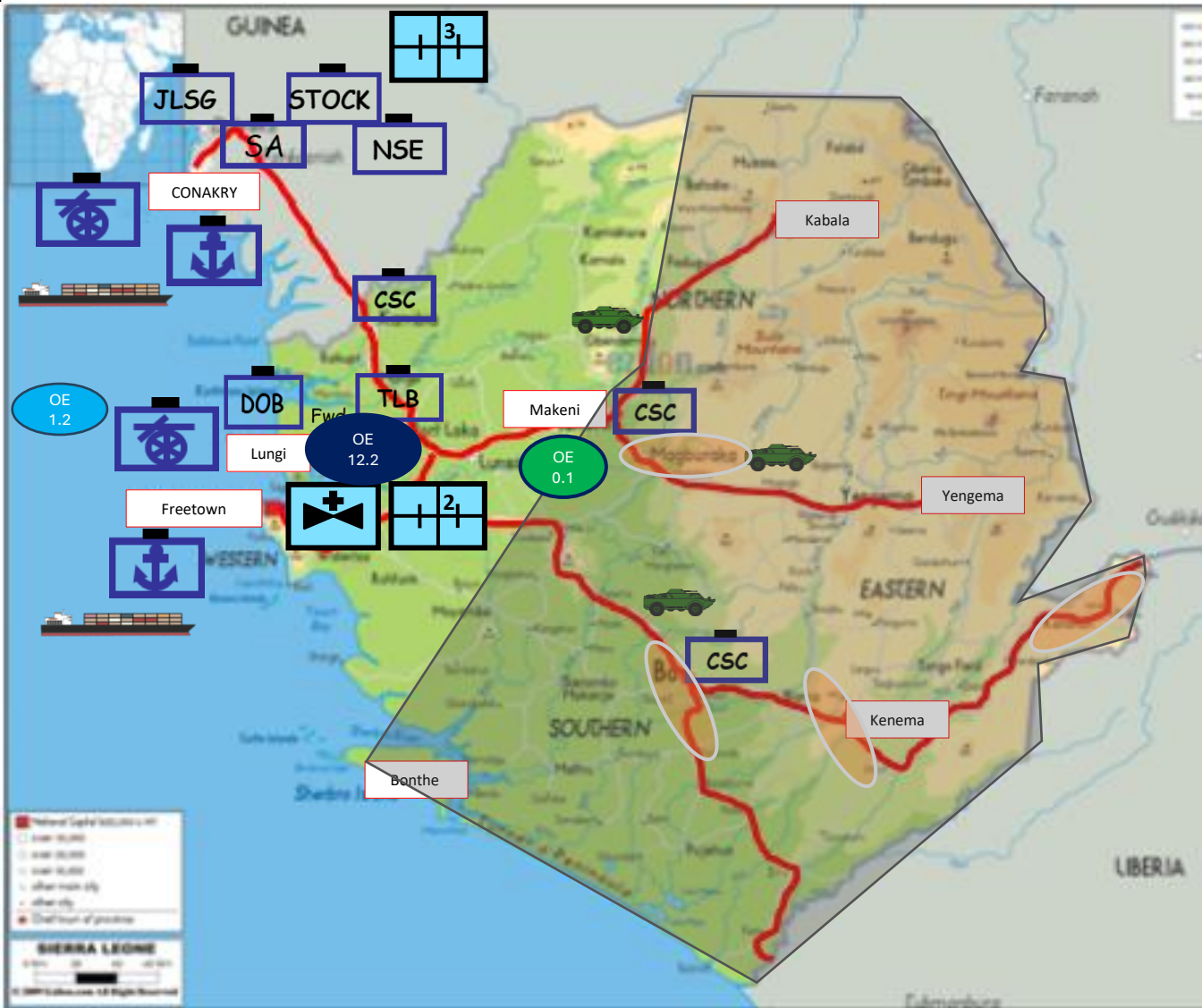
- a. **JFLCC (Supported):** Combined exercises and continued progressive transfer of lead to RSLMF. LLOC tasks clearing, patrolling, checkpoints, convoy escort.
- b. **JFACC:** Provide air support for all actions in SL+ ISR
- c. **JFMCC:** No change
- d. **C-SOCC:** Counter-terrorist actions on MSR + Diamond mines
- e. **POTF:** Promote RSLMF success & legitimacy, Influence and discourage ops, Inform local population
- f. **CYBER:** No change
- g. **Operational Reserve:** 1x Light Infantry Bde (QRF)

## PHASE 3: Enforce

**Purpose:** *Secure IDP camps and diamond mining areas*

**Start:** D + 520 days

**End: D + 650 days**



**Narrative:**

*“Forces secure IDP/refugee camps and the Liberian border while protecting civilians and enabling humanitarian access. Diamond mining areas are cleared of RUF/AFRC presence and defended, as Liberian forces are deterred and their links to armed groups disrupted. Concurrently, RUF/AFRC is neutralized through influence, direct action, and reintegration efforts to restore stability in SL.”*

## 1. DC

- a. DC0 – KLE initial conditions established
- b. DC1 – SLOC Secured
- c. DC 7 IDP/Refugee camp secured
- d. DC 8 Liberian Border Secured
- e. DC 9 Diamond Mining Area Secured
- f. DC 10 Liberian forces deterred
- g. DC 11 RUF/AFRC neutralized

## 2. OE

- a. OE0.1 Coordinate and Inform Key Leadership
- b. OE1.2 Sea Control established
- c. OE 7.1/ 8.1/ 9.1 Understand the environment around IDP/Ref camp, mining area and the LIB border
- d. OE 7.2/ 8.2/ 9.2 Secure the IDP/Refugee camps, mining area and LIB border
- e. OE 7.3. Protect the Civilian population in camps and enable safe passage Hum Org
- f. OE 8.3 Deny Liberian Forces to cross the border with SL
- g. OE 8.4 Defend the border area with LIBERIA
- h. OE10.1 Compel and deter Liberian forces to be no longer involved within SL
- i. OE10.2 Disrupt the link between LIBERIA & RUF/AFRC
- j. OE11.1/2/3 Influence and destabilize and neutralize RUF/AFRC

### 3. Joint actions

- a. Show Force- collaboration with ECOMOG- Disrupt the link between LIBERIA & RUF/AFRC

#### 4. Component actions

- a. **JFLCC (Supported):** Secure, patrol, Checkpoint, Combat Engineering, Guard, disarm RUF/AFRC in key areas
- b. **JFACC:** Create air superiority west of the contact line+ ISR
- c. **JFMCC:** No Change
- d. **C-SOCC:** Recce, HUMINT, Detain key-leaders RUF/AFRC, direct actions key nodes
- e. **POTF:** CIMIC interact local population, PsyOps Counter RUF (disinformation), discourage RUF recruitment.
- f. **CYBER:** Disrupt digital propaganda, Degrade C2 OPFOR

**5. Operational Reserve:** 1x Light Infantry Bde (QRF)



PHASE 4: Transition

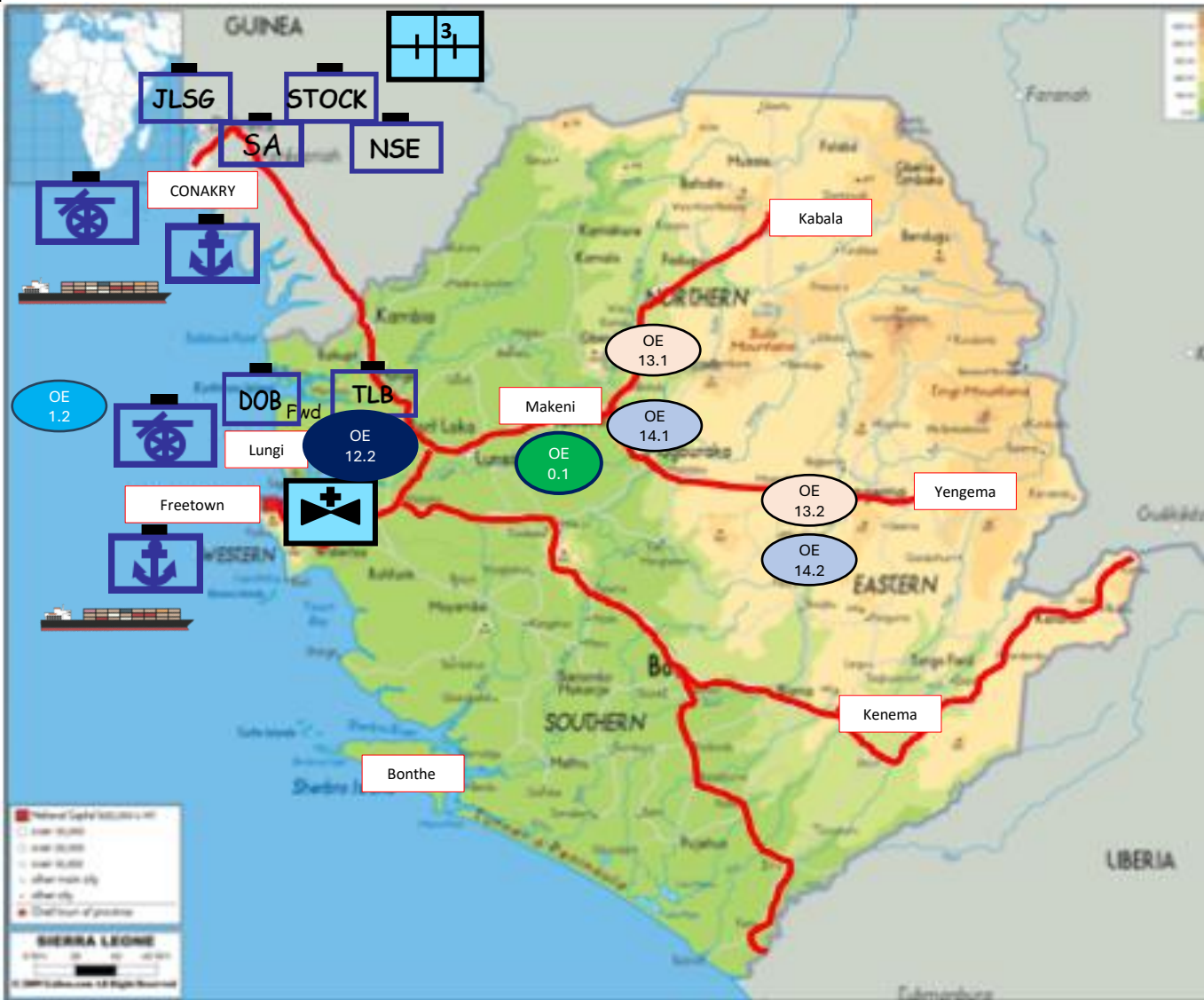
Purpose:

Start: D + 650 days

End: D + 720 days

Narrative:

“Once RSLMF and SL security forces are capable to control their territory and to safeguard their vital interests, WAFOR can hand-over the control of the territory, DDR & SSR process in hands of SL Gov. A nucleus can remain in place to support the HN with a smaller footprint”



1. DC

- a. DC0 – KLE initial conditions established
- b. DC1 – SLOC Secured
- c. DC 13 DDR Compounds/population center established iccw GOV SL in SL
- d. DC 14 RSLMF are FOC and able to take over Security role in SL

2. OE

- a. OE0.1 Coordinate and Inform Key Leadership
- b. OE1.2 Sea Control established
- c. OE 13.1. Support SL Gov in the DDR Process (all of SL
- d. OE 13.2. Guard the Compound iccw RSLMF during DDR-process
- e. OE 14.1. Develop & Support RSLMF to be able protection & security tasks in SL
- f. OE 14.2. Empower RSLMF

3. Joint actions

- a. HOTO & Redeploy
- b. Support smaller footprint
- c. Advise

4. Component actions

- a. JFLCC (Supported): HOTO, Guard, Redeploy, BPT support HN with smaller footprint, advise, liaise
- b. JFACC : Redeploy
- c. JFMCC: Escort RoRo with Hum. Aid, Redploy
- d. C-SOCC: HOTO, BPT support HN with smaller footprint & redeploy
- e. POTF: HOTO, inform,
- f. CYBER: Support HN

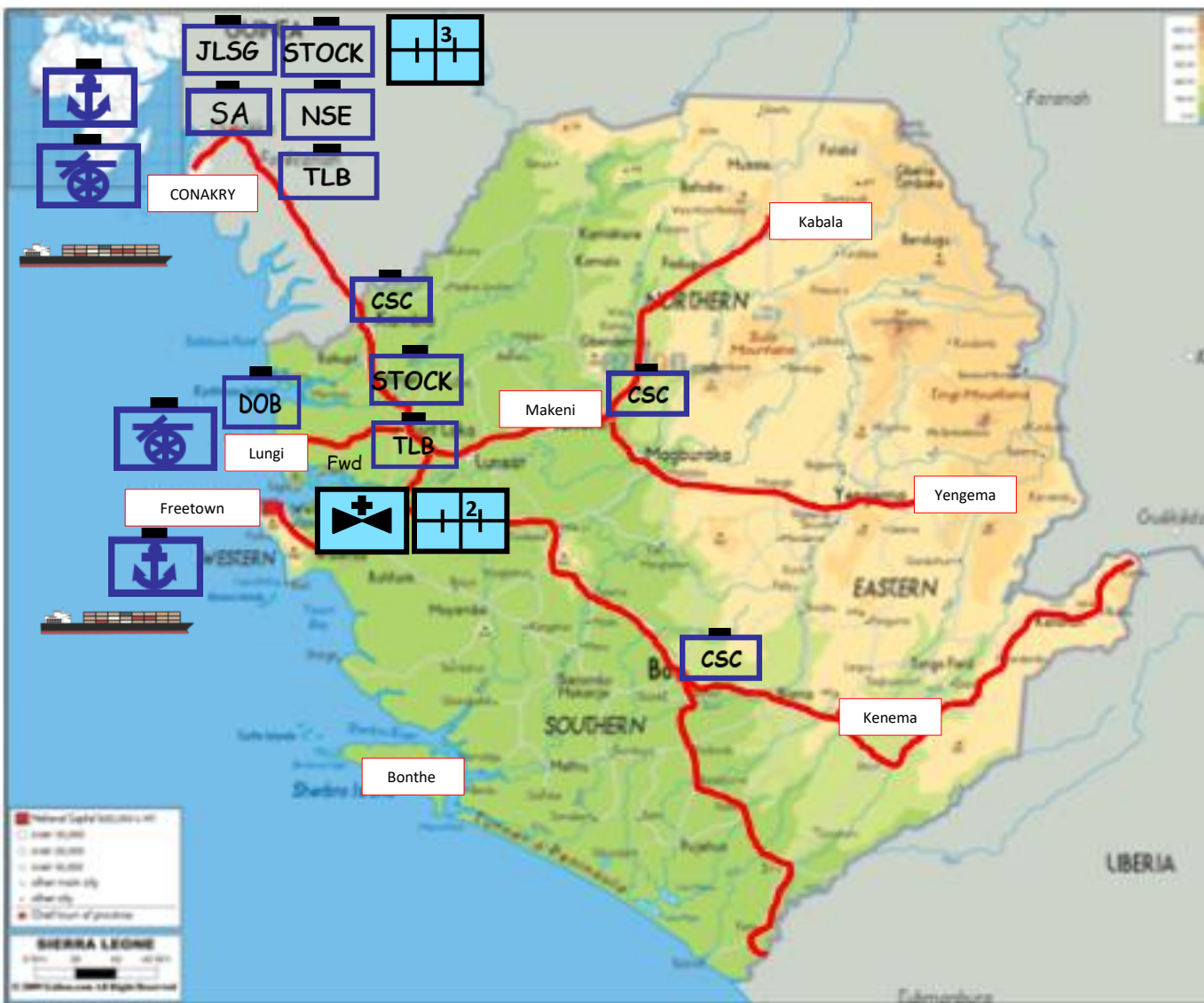
1. Operational Reserve: /

# Logistics

Purpose: Support WAFOR Ops

Start: ACTPRED

End: PHASE 4



## Log Sp concept:

- 2 SPOD/ 2 APOD (additional handling team requested)
- Dedicated FP for both Log installations and CSC on MSR
- CL I = contracting (combination NSPA and HNS)
- CL III = Logistic Lead Nation (LLN)
- For water = own water purification system is an absolute must
- Stockpile = 7 CDOS on Unit level 10 DOS in CONAKRY and FREETOWN
- CSC border as from phase 1, other CSC on main MSR as from phase 2C (+/- 100 Km)
- Support engineering
  - Phase 1-2 = improving harbour and port facilities in FREEPORT
  - Focus on water purification installation and improving Log facilities both in Guin as SL
  - As from phase 2C = focus on improving road conditions MSR

## Med Sp concept

- Absolute Prio Role 3 Med facility in Guinea + Medevac SL
- As from Phase 2A Role 2 in FREETOWN

HNS + 2 SPOD + Contracting + keep MSR open



## EARLY PHASES (Main Effort)

| WHEN                  | WHO                                      | HOW                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | SO WHAT                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|-----------------------|------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| SUB-PHASE             | MAIN KLE PRIORITIES                      | MAIN OAs                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | KEY CONCLUSIONS                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>0 – Deploy</b>     | GoSL / UN / ECOMOG / Humanitarian actors | OA.0.1.1 <i>Liaise with KL and key organisations</i> ; OA.0.1.2 <i>Link up with ECOMOG</i> ; OA.2.3.1 <i>Liaise with local authorities</i> ; OA.2.3.3 <i>Demonstrate WAFOR presence</i> ; <b>Proposed OA (MSU): Establish MSU liaison and urban security coordination cell</b>                                                                        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>“Strategic legitimacy first”</li> <li>“Secure APOD/SPOD access decisive”</li> <li>“Population perception critical from Day 1”</li> </ul>                                                          |
| <b>1 – Safe house</b> | NGOs / Community leaders / SLSF          | OA.4.6.2 <i>Protect civilian population</i> ; OA.4.6.3 <i>Secure safe passage to IDP camps</i> ; OA.4.7.1 <i>Conduct CIMIC OPS</i> ; OA.4.7.3 <i>Liaise with local leaders</i> ; OA.7.4.1 <i>Enable safe passage</i> ; <b>Proposed OA (MSU): Conduct urban reassurance patrols and protected presence operations</b>                                  | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>“Humanitarian security shapes legitimacy”</li> <li>“Narrative dominance essential”</li> <li>Good integration of FP/HP and CIMIC/Info Ops</li> <li>Good synchronisation with MSU effort</li> </ul> |
| <b>2A – Training</b>  | Chiefs / Border authorities / HUMINT     | OA.5A.1.1 <i>Mentor RSLMF by OMLT</i> ; OA.5A.1.2 <i>Liaise with RSLMF</i> ; OA.6A.1.1 <i>Clear routes and assure humanitarian passage</i> ; OA.8.1.1 <i>Build SA on border</i> ; OA.11.1.2 <i>Encourage population support against RUF</i> ; <b>Proposed OA (MSU): Support population-centric mentoring and joint security engagement with RSLMF</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Main client is RSMLF</li> <li>Good integration between WAFOR and RSMLF units</li> </ul>                                                                                                           |

### Key Message

- Key requirements: POLAD, J10, J9, MSU, Cyber, Gender advisor
- Key strategies: STRATCOM, Info/CIMIC/PsyOps, Gender-based approach
- Additional liaisons: MSU, RSMLF leadership, UNSrSG
- Main effort: RSMLF units (OMLT), Joint staff functions, HNS APOD
- Key residual integration WAFOR Air Sp: MEDEVAC, CAS and ISR





## LATER PHASES

| WHEN                               | WHO                                                  | HOW                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | SO WHAT                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| SUB-PHASE                          | MAIN KLE PRIORITIES                                  | MAIN OAs                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | KEY CONCLUSIONS                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>2B – Integration &amp; HOTO</b> | ECOWAS / Media / Moderate insurgent actors           | OA.5B.1.2 <i>Conduct joint patrols with ECOMOG and RSLMF</i> ; OA.5C.3.2 <i>Establish joint C2 procedures</i> ; OA.5C.3.3 <i>Conduct combined patrols and operations</i> ; OA.11.1.1 <i>Diminish RUF disinformation</i> ; OA.11.2.2 <i>Detain key leaders</i> ; <b>Proposed OA (MSU): Conduct integrated MSU-RSLMF joint urban patrols and HOTO security operations</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Deepen integration from unit to joint operations</li> <li>• Deepen integration across Instruments of Power</li> </ul>                               |
| <b>2C – Mov up</b>                 | UN mediators / Tribal brokers / Regional actors      | OA.10.2.1 <i>Demonstrate and show of force</i> ; OA.10.3.1 <i>Interdict supply lines</i> ; OA.12.1.1 <i>Liaise with SL Government for DDR</i> ; OA.12.2.3 <i>Cooperate with RSLMF</i> ; OA.13.1.1 <i>Support DDR process</i> ; <b>Proposed OA (MSU): Secure key population centres and support DDR site preparation</b>                                                 | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Increase in risk level</li> <li>• Increase in need for firepower and tactical mobility</li> </ul>                                                   |
| <b>3 – Enforce</b>                 | DDR actors / Former combatants / Security leadership | OA.11.2.1 <i>Suppress RUF/AFRC</i> ; OA.11.2.2 <i>Detain key leaders</i> ; OA.12.2.1 <i>Guard DDR compounds</i> ; OA.12.2.2 <i>Patrol perimeter</i> ; OA.13.2.1 <i>Guard compounds with RSLMF</i> ; <b>Proposed OA (MSU): Conduct urban security, checkpoint operations and DDR compound protection</b>                                                                 | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Alternate APOD crucial for deterrence and Air SP</li> <li>• Increase in logistical footprint to sustain COIN</li> <li>• KLE also crucial</li> </ul> |
| <b>4 – Transition</b>              | Government / Judiciary / Police / Donors             | OA.14.1.1 <i>Mentor RSLMF by OMLT</i> ; OA.14.1.2 <i>Liaise with RSLMF</i> ; OA.14.2.1 <i>Inform local population</i> ; OA.14.2.3 <i>Advise and liaise with RSLMF</i> ; OA.14.2.4 <i>Relieve in place</i> ; <b>Proposed OA (MSU): Support transition to Rule of Law and internal security institutions</b>                                                              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Establish KPAs and MoP for draw down and transition</li> <li>• Track KPA's and MoP</li> </ul>                                                       |

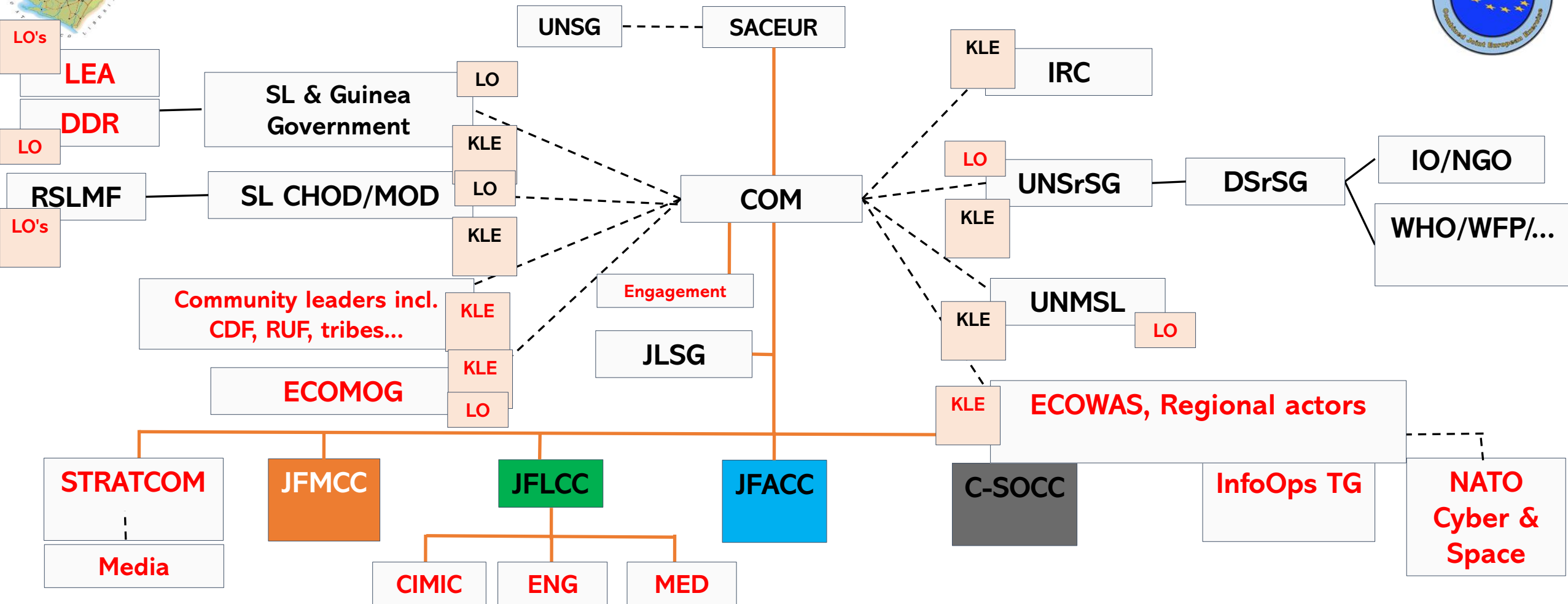
### Key Messages:

- Shift in main KLE effort in sync with/prior to scheme of maneuver
- Managing stakeholder expectations w.r.t. casualties
- Need for a Performance Measurement and Management System – based evaluation and transition





# Preliminary C2 Arrangements



## Key changes: Enhanced commander options and support

- Additional LO's and KLE activities
- Additional staff functions: POLAD, J9, J10, Gender advisor...
- Integration of information effects: Cyber, space, info ops, and STRATCOM
- Integration of CIMIC/MED/Eng supporting LCC
- Division of labour COM WAFOR and engagement cell regarding KLE

----- DIRLAUTH  
——— OPCON



# OUTLINE



| # | WHAT                                          | WHO | TIME |
|---|-----------------------------------------------|-----|------|
| 1 | Political and SACEUR Decision and Guidance    | LDR | 1    |
| 2 | Commander's OPG Decision and Guidance         | LDR | 1    |
| 3 | Opposing Courses of Actions                   | J2  | 5    |
| 4 | OPG Highlights & Situation Analysis (update)  | J5  | 3-5  |
| 5 | Own Forces Courses of Actions (CARBON CRUSH)  | J5  | 12   |
| 6 | Analysis and Comparison of Courses of Actions | J5  | 5-8  |
| 7 | Conclusion                                    | LDR | 2    |
| 8 | Commander's Decision and Guidance             | LDR | 1    |



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# COA 2 – CARBON CRUSH

## General CONOPS



### Narrative:

The COA is **threat-focused, prioritizing rebel activity and Liberian influence**, while remaining comprehensive by integrating enabling actors and **influence the entire Sierra Leonean population** by a strong Info Ops/StratCom Campaign as from the beginning.

It provides **robustness, deterrence and force protection**, while preserving dialogue and non-kinetic options through a gradual and controlled escalation to pressure rebels to respect peace agreements. **If required**, it commits to **decisive and definitive kinetic actions** to support our coercion strategy and ensure the protection of our forces. In this scope **a strong mobile reserve** will be kept at JFC level.



# Joint Force Package Capability Estimate

Force package based on a **5–45-day NTM** generation window. Forces drawn from NATO Force Catalogue Tier 1, 2 and 3.



**LCC – Tier 1/2**  
**ONE Mech Bde Tier 1**  
**ONE Lt Bde Tier 2 (ONE Lt Bn JFC Reserve)**  
**ONE Mech Bde Tier 2**



**LCC - Tier 3**  
**UH HELOS**  
**ONE Eng BDE**

**MCC – Tier 1**  
**ONE SNMG**  
**ONE SSK**  
**ONE SNMCMG**  
**ONE MPA**



**MCC – Tier 3**  
**CARRIER TASK GROUP (Nov26-May27)**  
**Amphibious Task Group**

**ACC – Tier 1/2**  
**AEW**  
**EW**  
**TAC RECON**  
**FIGHTERS**  
**BOMBERS**  
**MSL**  
**TPT**



**ACC - Tier 3**  
**ONE TRX/TRO/TRI Sqn**

**JLSG**  
**ONE RSOI**  
**ONE LOG Sp Gp**  
**ONE Med Sp Gp / Role 3 MTF**



**LCC - Tier 3**  
**ONE Inf Bn (FP)**

**SOF**  
**FOUR SOTG Tier 1**  
**TWO SOTG Tier 2**

## **SACEUR RESERVE**

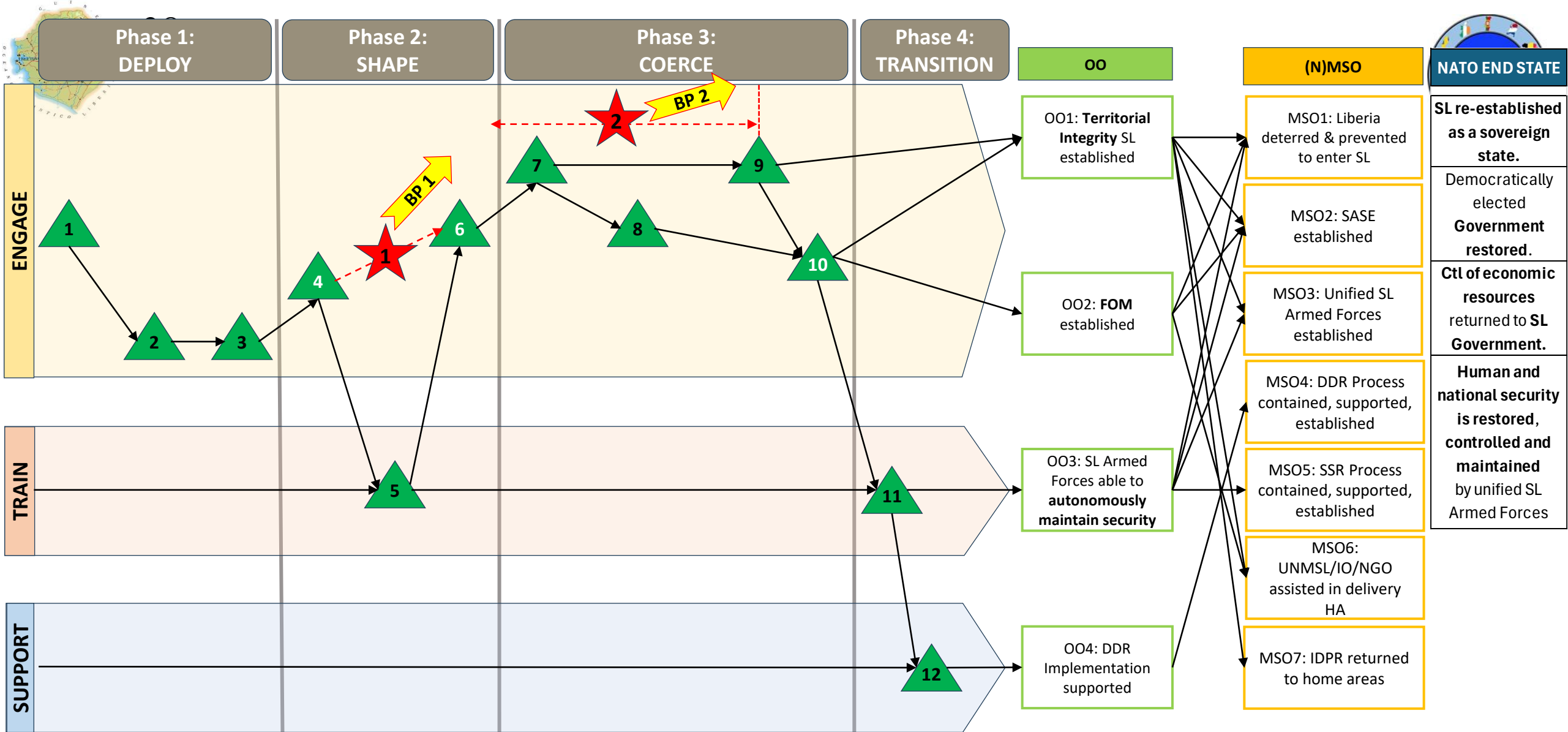
**ONE Inf Bde – Tier 3**

**NATO Expanded Task Force**

**Multirole Fighters**

**ONE SOTG**





| Decisive Conditions (DC) |                       |   |                                 |    |                                |
|--------------------------|-----------------------|---|---------------------------------|----|--------------------------------|
| 1                        | SLOC Secured          | 5 | RSLMF integrated in WAFOR FOB   | 9  | Liberian Forces Deterred       |
| 2                        | APOD Lungi Secured    | 6 | SASU Established                | 10 | RUF/AFRC Neutralized/Destroyed |
| 3                        | SPOD Freetown Secured | 7 | Liberian border area Controlled | 11 | RSLMF FOC & able to HOTO SL    |
| 4                        | LLOC to FOB Secured   | 8 | Diamond mines Controlled        | 12 | DDR Process Facilitated        |

| Decision Point (DP) |                       |
|---------------------|-----------------------|
| 1                   | RSLMF not IOC         |
| 2                   | Liberian intervention |

| Branch Plan (BP) |                  |
|------------------|------------------|
| 1                | Solo slim        |
| 2                | Return to sender |

PHASE 1: DEPLOY

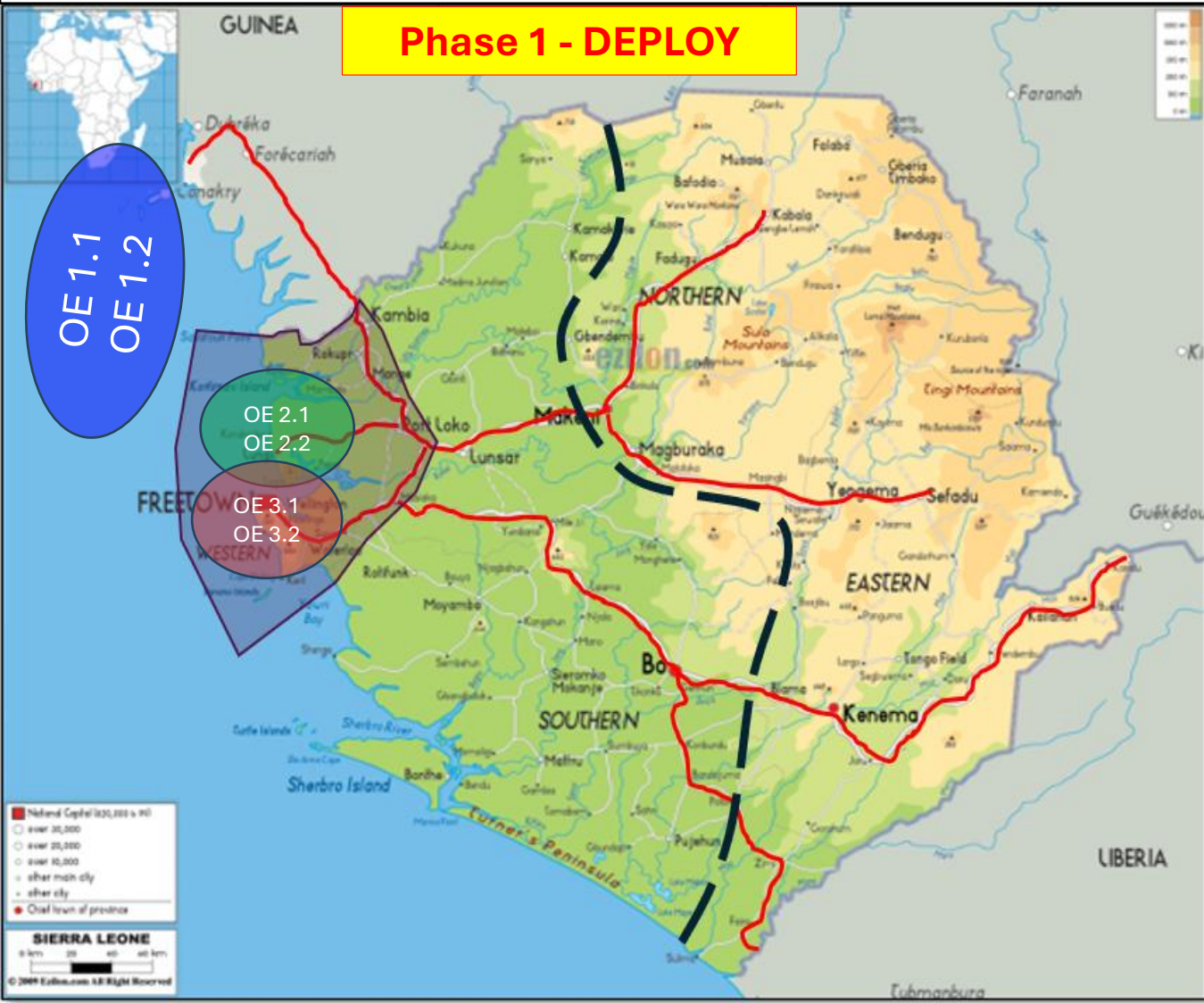
**Purpose:** Initial Entry and Build Up

**Start:** 1st Move (Aug 2026)

**End:** SLOCs, APOD Lungi and SPOD Freetown Secured (Oct 2026)

Narrative:

During the deployment phase, we will **build a robust force** in a secure and controlled manner. **Tier 1,2 forces** and selected elements of **Tier 3** will be **deployed** in the vicinity of the Freetown area.



1. DC



SLOC Secured



SPOD Freetown Secured



APOD Lungi Secured

1. OE

OE 1.1 Develop Maritime Forces

OE 1.2 Sea Control established

OE 2.1 Develop FP around Airport Lungi

OE 2.2 Defend Airport Lungi

OE 3.1 Develop harbour Protection around Freetown harbour

OE 3.2 Defend harbour of Freetown

3. OA

OA 1.1.1 Deploy Maritime Forces before coast of Guinea

OA.1.1.2 Deploy Mar. Forces Freetown

OA.1.1.3 Build up the Maritime SA

OA 1.2.1 Patrol

OA 1.2.2 Escort RoRo

OA 2.1.1 Build SA

OA 2.1.2 Deploy FP forces

OA 2.1.3 Defeat AA around Lungi

OA 2.2.1 Patrol & monitor around Lungi

OA 2.2.2 Build up FP capability and structure

OA 3.1.1 Build SA

OA 3.1.2 Deploy HP forces

OA 3.1.3 Patrol & monitor

OA 3.2.1 Build up FP capability and structure

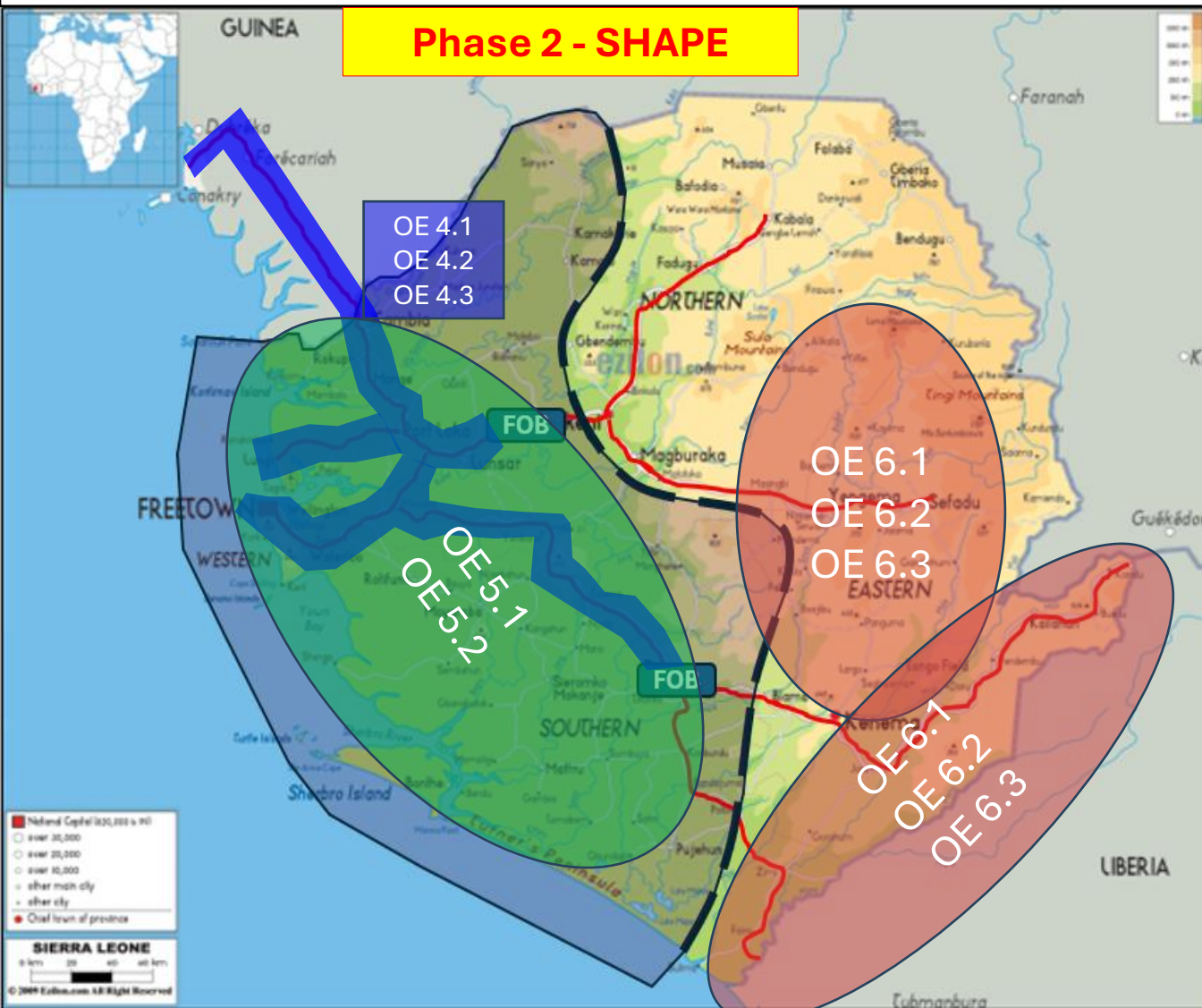
4. Supported Component: JLSCG

## PHASE 2: SHAPE

## Purpose: Stabilization and Expansion of Control

**Start:** WAFOR moves East (Oct 2026)

**End:** Makeni and Bo FOB established (Dec 2026)



**Narrative:**

During the shaping phase, we **will stabilize western Sierra Leone** in close coordination with the RSLMF. Concurrently, we will **develop a clear and comprehensive situational awareness** across the entire JOA, with particular emphasis on the southeastern regions.

1. **DC**
- 4 LLOC to FOB Secured
  - 5 RSLMF Integrated in WAFOR FOB
  - 6 SASU Established
2. **OE**
- OE 4.1 Secure LLOC to FOB
  - OE 4.2 Protect and Control LLOC
  - OE 4.3 Escort convoys in LLOC
  - OE 5.1 Develop & Support RSLMF to be able to conduct defensive tasks in Western SL
  - OE 5.2 Empower RSLMF to take over protection of LLOC to FOB and enable security in Western SL
  - OE 6.1 Find all rebels and Liberian positions in SL
  - OE 6.2 Shape future targeting Ops
  - OE 6.3 Understand Enemy Ops
3. **OA**
- OA 4.1.1 Clear Routes to FOBs
  - OA 4.1.2 Patrol LLOC
  - OA 4.1.3 Establish control points
  - OA 4.2.1 Guard checkpoints
  - OA 4.2.2 Deny unauthorized access
  - OA 4.2.3 Conduct Recce on routes
  - OA 4.3.1 Protect/escort/screen/react when in contact
  - OA 5.1.1 Mentor RSLMF by OMLT
  - OA 5.1.2 Liaise with RSLMF to support them throughout the deployment
  - OA 5.2.1 Inform the local population
  - OA 5.2.2 Advise and liaise with RSLMF
  - OA 5.2.3 Promote RSLMF with local population
  - OA 5.2.4 Relieve in place
  - OA 6.1.1 Confirm rebels disposition
  - OA 6.2.1 Designate future targets
  - OA 6.2.2 Detect LIB land force in SL
  - OA 6.2.3 Conduct recce of mines
  - OA 6.3.1 Collect data and information in rebels area
  - OA 6.3.2 Search for insurgents
  - OA 6.3.3 Identify hostile activities in Easterns SL
  - OA 6.3.4 Locate rebel C2
  - OA 6.3.5 Screen LIB borders
4. **Supported Component: LCC**



## PHASE 3: COERCE

## Purpose: Isolate, Control and Deter

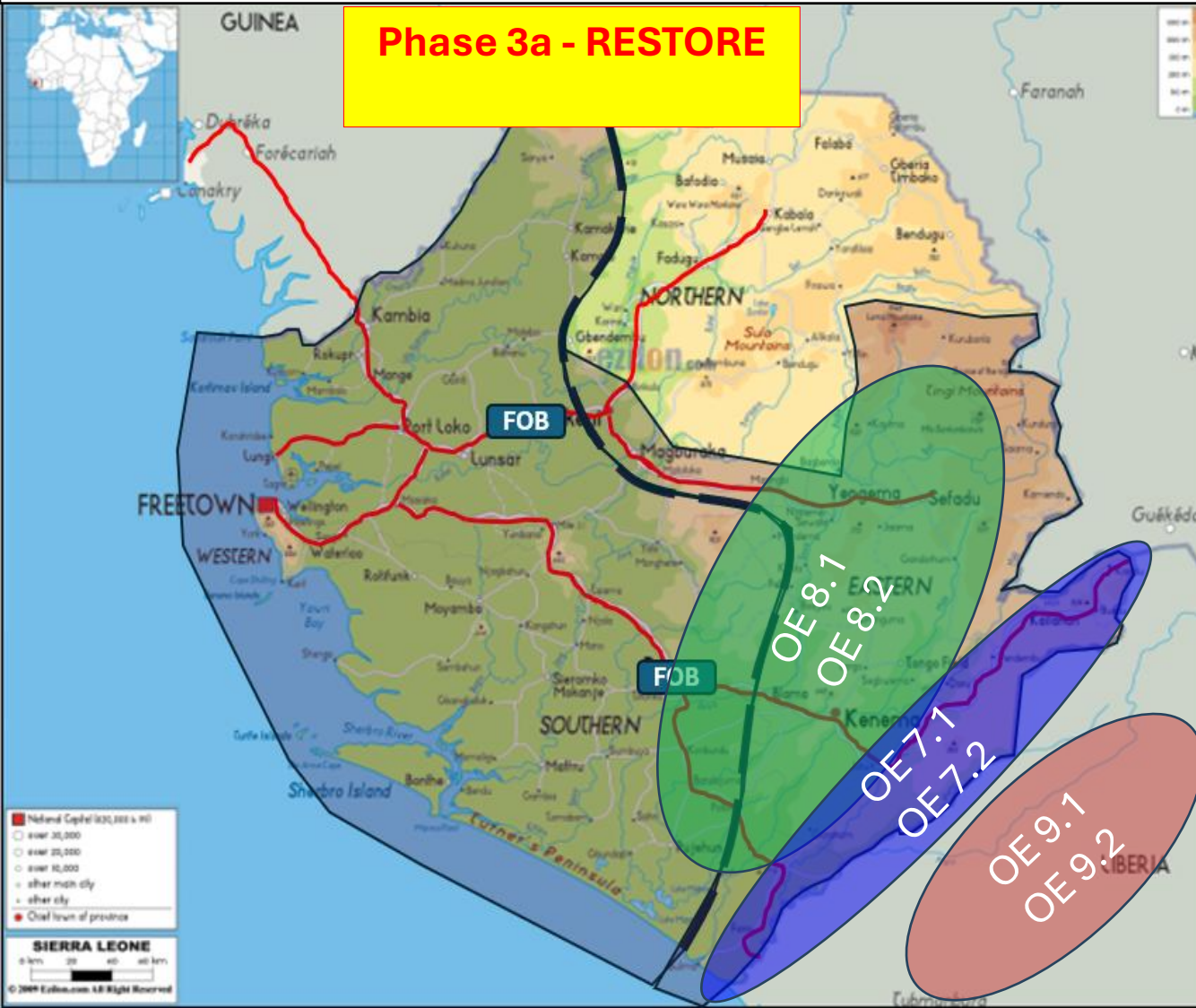
**Start:** Move to Liberian border (Dec 2026)

**End: AFRC/RUF capability Neutralized (Dec 2027)**

**Narrative:**

*This phase is divided into two sub-phases: **Restore** and **Defeat**.*

**Restore** focuses on **cutting Liberian support to the rebels and regaining control of diamond network** . It aims to systematically and sequentially dismantle rebel influence and freedom of action in the southeastern regions, ensuring that created vacuum is immediately filled by Sierra Leone government authorities.



1. **DC**
- 7  Liberian border area Controlled
  - 8  Diamond mines Controlled
  - 9  Liberian Forces Deterred
1. **OE**
- OE 7.1 Understand the environment around the border of Liberia and SL
  - OE 7.2 Deny Liberian Forces to cross the border with SL
  - OE 8.1 Understand the environment around diamond mining areas
  - OE 8.2 Secure and Clear the diamond mining areas from RUF/AFRC
  - OE 9.1 Coerce Liberian Forces to be no longer involved within SL
  - OE 9.2 Disrupt the link between Liberia and RUF/AFRC
3. **OA**
- |                                       |                                                             |
|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| OA 7.1.1 Build SA                     | OA 9.1.1 Demonstrate force                                  |
| OA 7.1.2 Recce/Patrol border          | OA 9.1.2 Interdict Liberian forces                          |
| OA 7.1.3 Monitor border               | OA 9.1.3 Diminish LIB influence into SL                     |
| OA 7.2.1 Detect any LIB incursion     | OA 9.2.1 Interdict supply lines                             |
| OA 7.2.1 Strike Liberian forces in SL | OA 9.2.2 Interrupt communication and logistic lines         |
| OA 8.1.1 Build up SA                  | OA 9.3.1 Promote NATO legitimacy, commitment and capability |
| OA 8.1.2 Recce Area                   |                                                             |
| OA 8.1.3 Monitor                      |                                                             |
| OA 8.2.1 Frighten RUF                 |                                                             |
| OA 8.2.2 Occupy mines                 |                                                             |
| OA 8.2.3 Interdict RUF forces         |                                                             |
| OA 8.2.4 Link up with Western forces  |                                                             |
4. **Supported Component: LCC**



PHASE 3: COERCE

**Purpose:** Isolate, Control and Deter

**Start:** Move to North (Enhanced Targeting Campaign) (Dec 2027)

**End:** AFRC/RUF capability Neutralized (Apr 2028)

**Narrative:**

This phase is divided into two sub-phases: **Restore** and **Defeat**.

**Defeat** aims at the **complete neutralization of RUF/AFRC forces**, thereby enabling the full restoration of Sierra Leone’s sovereignty, and includes readiness to conduct a final, decisive offensive should the RUF/AFRC fail to comply.



1. **DC**

 RUF/AFRC Neutralized/Destroyed

1. **OE**

OE 10.1 Influence and Destabilize

OE 10.2 Neutralize/Destroy RUF/AFRC

3. **OA**

OA 10.1.1 Discredit RUF/AFRC leadership

OA 10.1.2 Minimise the effectiveness of RUF/AFRC propaganda

OA 10.2.1 Degrade RUF/AFRC

OA 10.2.2 Detain key leaders

OA 10.2.3 Disarm combatants

OA 10.2.3 Conduct raid

OA 10.2.4 Attack

OA 10.2.5 Strike C2

4. **Supported Component: LCC**

PHASE 4: TRANSITION

**Purpose:** Transition responsibilities to local institutions  
**Start:** Sovereign Integrity Restored (Apr 2028)  
**End:** HOTO to SL Gov/RSLMF Completed (Aug 2028)

**Narrative:**  
The transition phase consists of the **handover** of all **WAFOR activities** to the reconstituted core of the RSLMF, while **enabling** the effective conduct of a comprehensive **SSR and DDR process**.



- DC**
  - 11** RSLMF FOC & able to HOTO SL
  - 12** DDR Process Facilitated
- OE**
  - OE 11.1 Develop and Support the RSLMF to be able to Execute protection and securing tasks in SL
  - OE 11.2 Empower RSLMF to take over security role from NATO in SL
  - OE 12.1 Support SL Government in DDR Process
  - OE 12.2 Guard the compound iccw RSLMF during DDR
- OA**
  - OA 11.1.1 Mentor RSLMF by OMLT
  - OA 11.1.2 Liaise with RSLMF to support them throughout the deployment
  - OA 11.2.1 Inform the local population
  - OA 11.2.2 Advise and liaise with RSLMF
  - OA 11.2.3 Promote RSLMF with local population
  - OA 11.2.4 Relieve in place
  - OA 12.1.1 Liaise with SL Gov for DDR
  - OA 12.1.2 Advise SL Government
  - OA 12.1.3 Medical Support
  - OA 12.2.1 Guard Compound
  - OA 12.2.2 Patrol Perimeter
  - OA 12.2.3 Liaise with Sec forces of SL and RSLMF
  - OA 12.3.1 In coordination with PA and PSYOPS, deliver messages to combatants and their families and supporters to cease violence and release weapons
- Supported Component: LCC**



## Key Message

In each Phase of this Campaign – Stratcom will be a vital **Golden** thread.

In a conflict defined by ***influence***, ***perception***, and ***legitimacy***, the force that controls the narrative will shape the conditions for strategic success

Effective STRATCOM will ***isolate*** the RUF/AFRC politically and psychologically while ***reinforcing the credibility*** of WAFOR and the Government of Sierra Leone.



# STRATCOM ACTIONS PHASE 1 — DEPLOY

(DC 1–3: SLOC / APOD / SPOD Secured)



**STRATCOM Objective in this Phase : “Legitimacy, Access & International Commitment”**

| ACTION                                                     | ACTORS                                             |
|------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Publicly <b>Establish</b> Coalition Legitimacy             | Government of Sierra Leone, UN, JFC, STRATCOM Cell |
| <b>Communicate</b> Restoration of Maritime & Air Access    | MCC, ACC, UNHAS, INFO OPS                          |
| <b>Counter</b> Adversary Disinformation Early              | INFO OPS, Intelligence Cell, STRATCOM              |
| <b>Reassure</b> Civil Population & International Community | CIMIC, NGOs, Local Media Networks                  |





## **STRATCOM ACTIONS PHASE 2 — SHAPE**

(DC 4–6: LLOC Secured / RSLMF Integration / SASU Established)



**STRATCOM** Objective in this Phase : “**Building Confidence, Governance & Partnership**”

### **ACTION**

**Promote** Host Nation Security Partnership

**Highlight** Restoration of Normal Civil Activity

**Establish** Strategic Engagement with Local Leaders

**Reinforce** Narrative of Long-Term Stabilisation

### **ACTORS**

RSLMF, JFC, STRATCOM

CIMIC, Local Authorities, INFO OPS

JFC, CIMIC, Governance Actors

UN, STRATCOM, Government of Sierra Leone



***STRATCOM Objective in this Phase : “Pressure, Isolation & Demonstration of Resolve”***

**ACTION**

**Isolate** RUF/AFRC Politically & Informationally

**Demonstrate** Coalition Resolve & Regional Unity

**Encourage** Civilian Cooperation & Reporting

**Publicise** Operational Successes Carefully

**ACTORS**

INFO OPS, UN, International Media

ECOMOG, MFA, STRATCOM

CIMIC, Police, Local Leaders

STRATCOM, JFC, Government Spokespersons



***STRATCOM Objective in this Phase : “Transition, Ownership & Sustainable Peace”***

**ACTION**

**Transition** Security Narrative to Sierra Leone Authorities

**Promote** DDR Participation & Reintegration

**Reinforce** Narrative of Enduring Stability

**Conduct** Symbolic Transition Events

**ACTORS**

Government of Sierra Leone, RSLMF, STRATCOM

UN DDR Agencies, NGOs, INFO OPS

UN, Government, International Partners

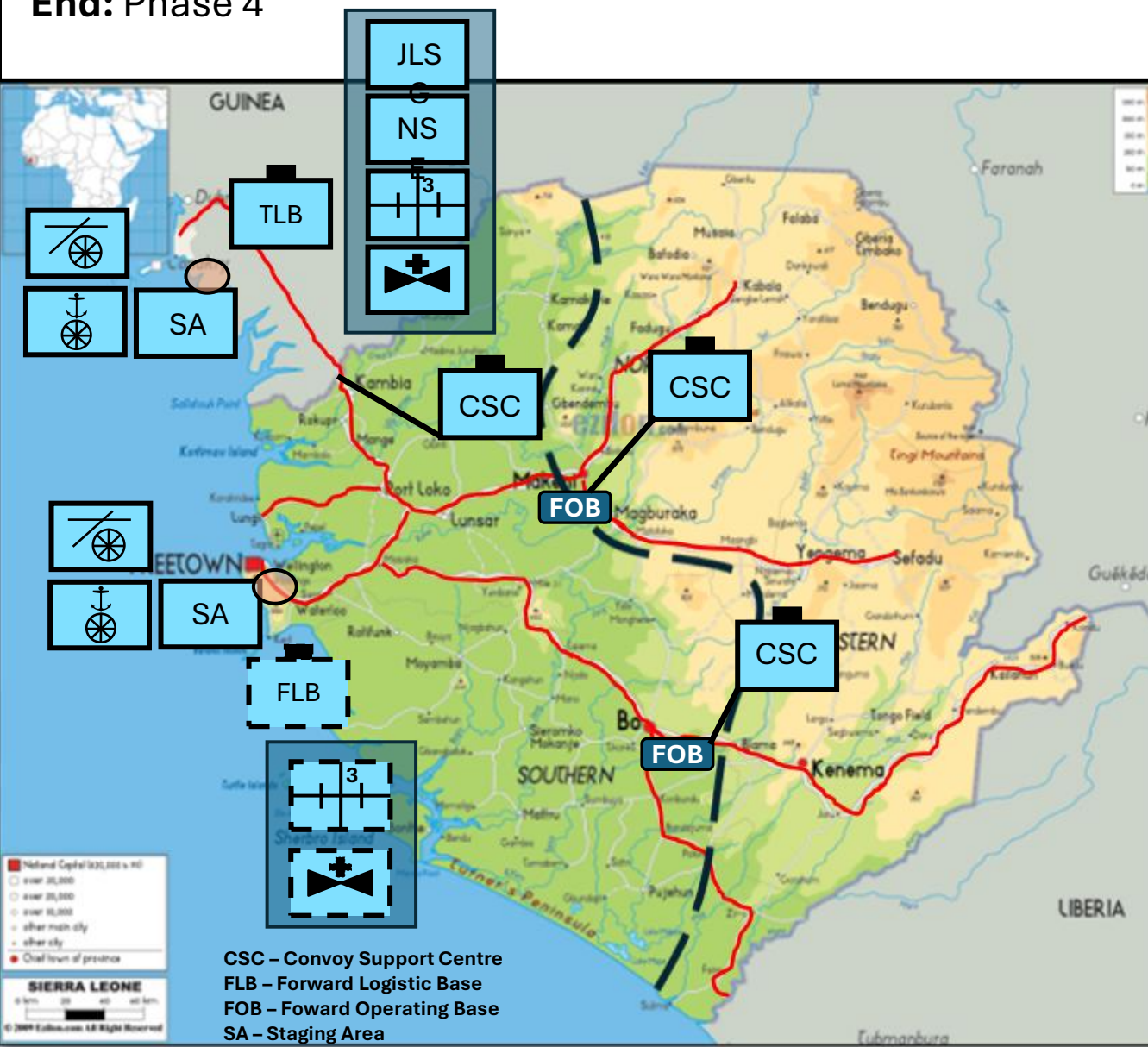
JFC, RSLMF, Government Leadership, Media

## LOGISTICS AND MEDICAL

**Purpose:** Support WAFOR operations

**Start:** Phase 1

**End:** Phase 4



## Logistic Support Concept:

- **TA with GUINEA and SIERRA LEONE** – use of infrastructures and provision of local civilian labour.
- **Class III** – NSPA acquisition (Phase 1) – HNS (Phase 2).
- **Class IW** – WAFOR self-sustained to drinking water.
- **Theatre Logistic Base** – CONAKRY.
- **Foward Logistic Base** – FREETOWN (Phase 3).
- **CSC integrated in the FOB** at MAKENI and BO.
- **Stockpile distribution:** 10 DOS – 10 DOS (Phase 3: 06 + 04 DOS) – 10 DOS
- **Military Engineering Support :**
  - **General Support** (Main Effort Phase 1)  
SPOD, APOD improvement – build up capabilities.
  - **Survivability Support**  
Accommodation, storage (Water, POL and ESMRM) – **Force Protection.**
  - **Mobility Support** (Main Effort Phase 2)  
MSR improvements

## Medical Support Concept:

- **Role 3 and MEDEVAC:** TLB (Phase 1) and FLB (Phase 3).
- **MEDEVAC:** 400/440 km - 2h (from CONAKRY)
- **Role 4 (strategic evacuation):** national responsibility

## Conclusions:

Logistically feasible if WAFOR secures early HNS arrangements and establishes a phased sustainment network from the TLB in CONAKRY to the FLB in FREETOWN.





## Initial Liason Schedule, KLE Framework and Justifications

President of Sierra Leone / Government Leadership

Sierra Leone MOD/CHOD/RSLMF Leadership

Tribal & Traditional Leaders

Key Humanitarian Actors & ECOMOG C2

Local Governance & Civil Authorities

Liberian Government Representation & Guinea Ldr

AFRC/RUF Intermediaries/Political Rep's

Former CDF & Local Security Actors

Community Leaders & Women Network  
IDP/Refugee Camps

Commercial Entities

### Key Principle

The Joint Force Commander's first engagement with the legitimate Government of Sierra Leone deliberately signals:

- **Respect** for sovereignty
- **Support** to constitutional authority
- **NATO commitment** to lawful intervention
- **Rejection** of insurgent legitimacy

### Commander's KLE Logic

The sequencing of engagement is designed to:

- |                    |                         |
|--------------------|-------------------------|
| • <b>Establish</b> | Legitimacy              |
| • <b>Secure</b>    | Operational access      |
| • <b>Build</b>     | Coordination mechanisms |
| • <b>Influence</b> | The population          |
| • <b>Isolate</b>   | Insurgent actors        |
| • <b>Deter</b>     | Regional escalation     |



# Provisional Component Tasks

## COA2 - CARBON CRUSH



### LCC

- Deploy
- Train
- Occupy
- Secure
- Control
- Handover

### SOCC

- Conduct SR
- BPT Conduct DA
- Enable local resistance
- Conduct KLE

### ACC

- Deploy
- Support
- Strike

### JLSG

- Deploy
- Supply
- Sustain
- Reconstruct

### MCC

- Deploy
- Secure SLOC
- Escort
- Interdict
- Strike



# OUTLINE



| # | WHAT                                          | WHO | TIME |
|---|-----------------------------------------------|-----|------|
| 1 | Political and SACEUR Decision and Guidance    | LDR | 1    |
| 2 | Commander's OPG Decision and Guidance         | LDR | 1    |
| 3 | Opposing Courses of Actions                   | J2  | 5    |
| 4 | OPG Highlights & Situation Analysis (update)  | J5  | 3-5  |
| 5 | Own Forces Courses of Actions (CIVIL SHIELD)  | J5  | 12   |
| 6 | Analysis and Comparison of Courses of Actions | J5  | 5-8  |
| 7 | Conclusion                                    | LDR | 2    |
| 8 | Commander's Decision and Guidance             | LDR | 1    |

From a risk perspective, WAFOR operations are ACCEPTABLE and SUITABLE provided that key mitigations are implemented. This table depicts key risks.

### **SLIDE CHANGE**

To mitigate risks common to both courses of action, WAFOR:

Must SECURE lines of communication with naval vessels and forces IVO LUNGI APOD

Must appoint a counter UAS lead nation & ensure that troop contributing nations provide their own sub-unit-level C-UAS.

Must allocate one additional infantry battalion, with engineers, for JLSG MSR protection.

Must ESTABLISH clear rule of engagement and marshalling of forces in GUINEA

Should OCCUPY GUINEA-SIERRA LEONE border crossings

Should employ STRATCOM and complementary non-military actions to DISCOURAGE LIBERIA

### **SLIDE CHANGE**

To mitigate risks to COA 1, WAFOR:

Must Request Carrier Group support, reinforce APOD and external AirOps capacity

Must expand ISR, SOF and HUMINT, with phased border-security and maritime interdiction operations.

Should accelerate MSU availability through Tier reinforcement or multinational policing solutions

Reinforce SFA and operational mentoring, maintain NATO enabling support and WAFOR QRF/QRA capability, while applying phased RSLMF combat integration and continuous operational assessment.

### **SLIDE CHANGE**

To mitigate risks to COA 2 , WAFOR:

Must enable host-nation forces to SECURE FREETOWN during Phase 1

Must use STRATCOM to REASSURE stakeholders IVO BONTHE/SHERBRO

Should use LIAISON & robust rules of engagement for the Joint Targeting Cell

Should ISOLATE mines prior to assault and ensure tactical SURPRISE

Should SECURE LIBERIA border crossings, conduct SSR and STRATCOM for miners





# Top Risks by COA



## Legend

- **Extremely High Risk; Mission Likely to Fail**
- **High Risk; Inability to Accomplish all Parts of the Mission**
- **Moderate Risk; Mission Accomplishment likely but possibility of reduced capability**
- **Low Risk; Little or No Impact on Accomplishment of the Mission**

| COA 1 Risk                                                               | Prob | Impact On/Severity | Mitigation                                                                                                                                                                                  | AM     | Conclusion                                                                                                                                                   |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|--------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Risk 1 - Limited strategic deterrence due absence of Carrier-based AirOp | M    | High               | Request Carrier Group support, reinforce APOD and external AirOps capacity, while increasing ISR, maritime surveillance and visible deterrence posture.                                     | Green  | Conditionally acceptable – could become acceptable (MODERATE / LOW) if strategic air and deterrence mitigation measures are implemented early.               |
| Risk 2 - Freetown not secured and stabilized by D+180                    | H    | High               | Accelerate MSU availability through Tier reinforcement or multinational policing solutions, integrated with CIMIC, HUMINT and GoSL security coordination.                                   | Yellow | Conditionally acceptable – could become acceptable (MODERATE / MODERATE) if early public-security mitigation measures are implemented.                       |
| Risk 3 - Liberian border not secured early enabling AFRC/RUF sanctuary   | M    | High               | Expand ISR, SOF and HUMINT coverage while reinforcing regional engagement and phased border-security and maritime interdiction operations.                                                  | Green  | Conditionally acceptable – could become acceptable (MODERATE / LOW) through strengthened regional containment and border-control measures.                   |
| Risk 4 - RSLMF unable to achieve required operational effectiveness      | H    | HIGH               | Reinforce SFA and operational mentoring, maintain NATO enabling support and WAFOR QRF/QRA capability, while applying phased RSLMF combat integration and continuous operational assessment. | Yellow | Conditionally acceptable   Could become acceptable (MODERATE / MODERATE) with sustained mentoring, enabling support and phased integration measures applied. |
| COA 2 Risk                                                               | Prob | Impact On/Severity | Mitigation                                                                                                                                                                                  | AM     | Conclusion                                                                                                                                                   |
| Insurgency persists                                                      | M    | Moderate           | ISOLATE and SURPRISE. DDR                                                                                                                                                                   | Green  | LIKELY to persist to some degree                                                                                                                             |
| OPFOR RETAIN partial diamond funding                                     | M    | Moderate           | SECURING the border crossings, SSR, encourage miners to work for GoSL                                                                                                                       | Green  | LIKELY to persist to some degree                                                                                                                             |
| Excessive civilian casualties                                            | M    | High               | Robust ROEs, careful liaison with Joint Targeting Cell                                                                                                                                      | Yellow |                                                                                                                                                              |
| Status of BON/SHERBRO mishandled                                         | H    | Extremely high     | LIAISON and STRATCOM WAFOR operations until Phase 3                                                                                                                                         | Yellow | Key CCP consideration. May be LIBERIAN red line                                                                                                              |
| Common Risk                                                              | Prob | Impact On/Severity | Mitigation                                                                                                                                                                                  | AM     | Conclusion                                                                                                                                                   |
| WITHDRAWAL of MOU                                                        | M    | Moderate           | Robust ROEs, SECURE border crossings, MOU with GAMBIA                                                                                                                                       | Green  | FOB at border GUINEA-SL border crossings required                                                                                                            |
| XLOCs DENIED                                                             | M    | High               | Anti-submarine vessels, SECURE LUNGI APOD, robust MSR protection                                                                                                                            | Yellow | Threat to MSRs likely to persist to highest degree                                                                                                           |
| Low tolerance for cas.                                                   | H    | Extremely High     | C-UAS lead nation, organic C-UAS at all levels, unpredictable routines                                                                                                                      | Yellow | Lead nation for C-UAS likely COR                                                                                                                             |
| GoSL collapse                                                            | M    | High               | SECURE FREETOWN in Phase 1, liaison and mentoring, CNMA                                                                                                                                     | Yellow | Likely to dissipate gradually as mission progresses                                                                                                          |
| LIBERIAN escalation                                                      | M    | High               | Strategic CNMA, care WRT SHERBRO population                                                                                                                                                 | Green  | Likely to dissipate gradually as mission progresses                                                                                                          |
| IDPs disrupt FREETOWN                                                    | M    | Extremely High     | LIAISON with NGOs                                                                                                                                                                           | Green  | Likely to dissipate gradually as mission progresses                                                                                                          |



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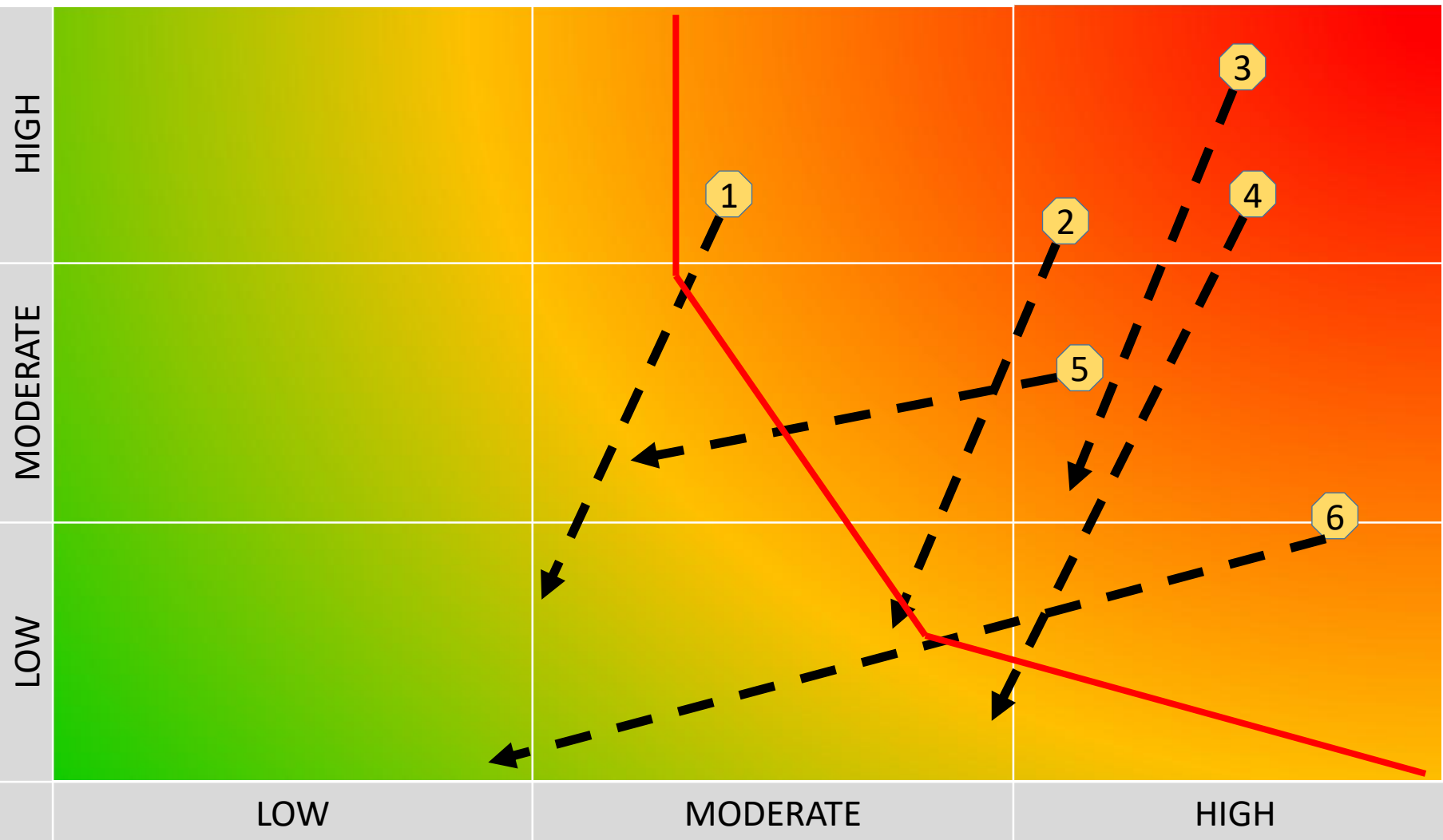
ACCEPTABLE RISKS

UNACCEPTABLE RISKS



Common Risks  
to both COAs

PROBABILITY



LOW

MODERATE

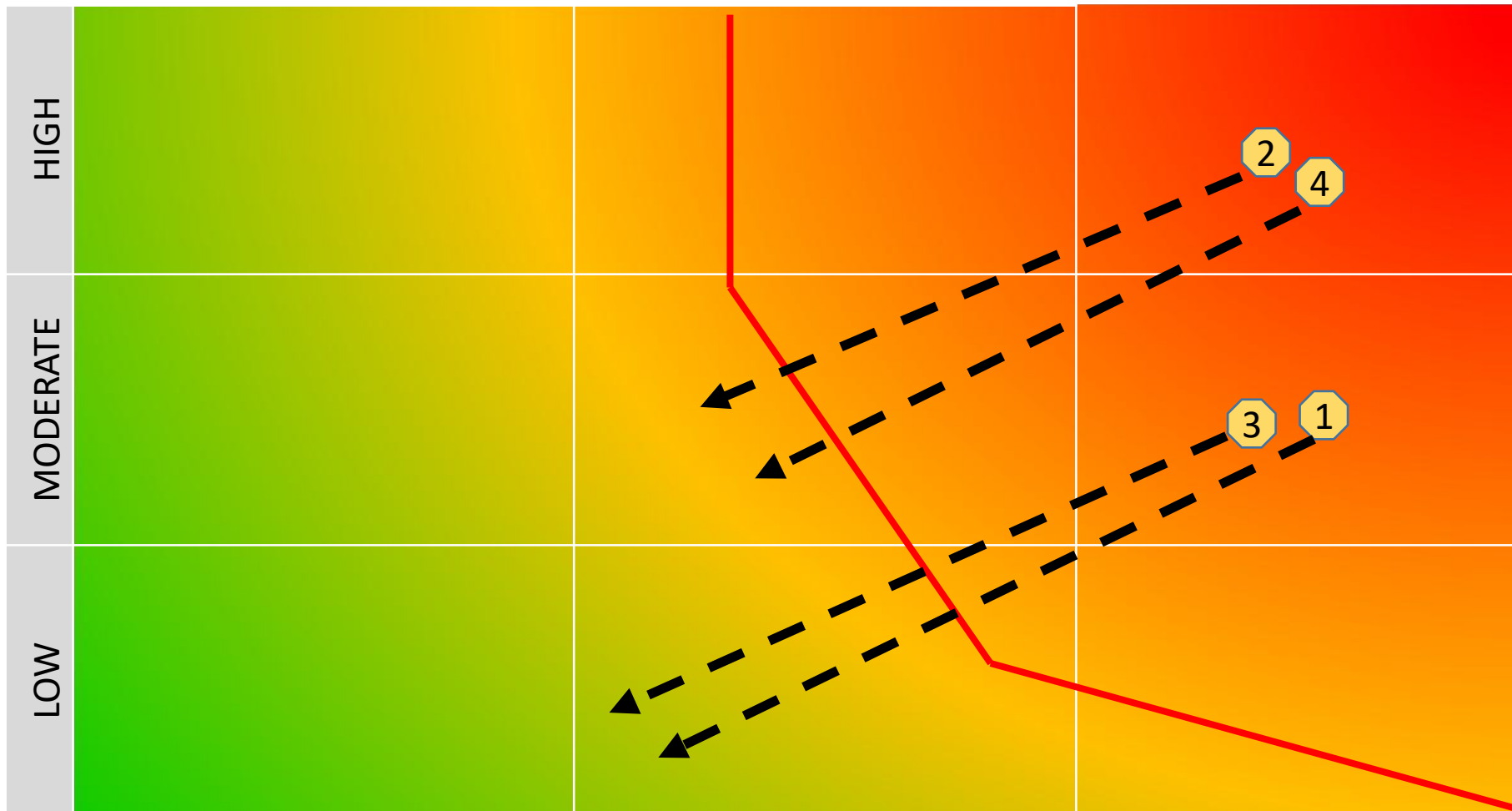
HIGH

| Serial | Risk                                     | Serial | Risk                                |
|--------|------------------------------------------|--------|-------------------------------------|
| 1      | WITHDRAWAL of GUINEA tech. agreement: 4C | 4      | GoSL collapse during Phase 1: 4D    |
| 2      | XLOCs DENIED: 4D                         | 5      | IDPs DISRUPT WAFOR IVO FREETOWN: 3D |
| 3      | Low WARFOR tolerance of casualties: 5D   | 6      | LIBERIAN escalation: 2E             |



## COA 1 Risks

PROBABILITY



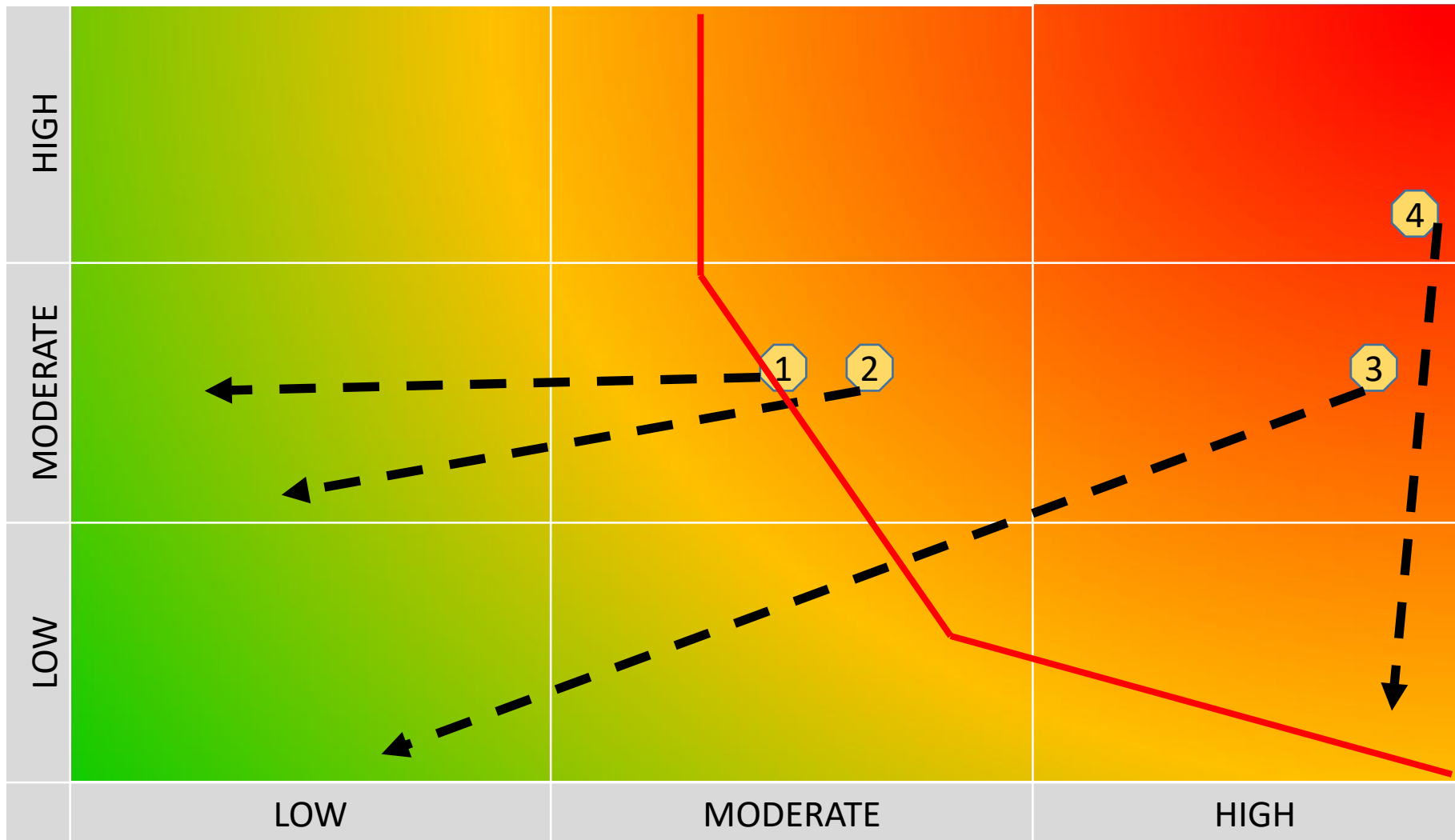
| Serial | Risk                                                                        |
|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1      | Limited strategic deterrence due to absence of carrier-based air operations |
| 2      | Freetown not secured and stabilized by D+180                                |
| 3      | LIBERIAN border not SECURED enabling AFRC/RUF sanctuary                     |
| 4      | RSLMF unable to achieve required operational effectiveness                  |



## COA 2 Risks



PROBABILITY





Sir, following the mission analysis brief you specifically highlighted the drone threat.

Your low casualty tolerance makes it a key risk.

NATO has no agreed capability codes or statements for organic hard-kill.

Drones are a particular threat to static combat units, soft-skin convoys and JLSN nodes.

Designating existing forces for C-UAS will reduce the combat-power of the WAFOR.

Designating C-UAS as solely a national requirement without COMWAFOR-level oversight constitutes a coordination and coverage risk.

Hence,

COMWAFOR must designate a lead nation to protect the main nodes of the JLSN.

COMWAFOR must ensure that during force generation, contributing nations provide forces responsible for their own sub-unit-level C-UAS.



# Counter UAS (C-UAS) Considerations



| Constraints                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Force Design Considerations                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Conclusions                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• C-UAS capability gap</li><li>• No agreed organic hard-kill C-UAS capability line at sub-unit level.</li><li>• Static combat units, soft-skin convoys, JLSN nodes, LUNGI APOD and FREETOWN SPOD are <b>high-payoff drone targets</b>.</li><li>• RSOM and sustainment movement are the greatest risks.</li><li>• Low casualty tolerance makes C-UAS an operational-level force protection problem.</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• COMWAFOR cannot assume C-UAS will appear through normal force generation.</li><li>• If existing WAFOR combat forces are re-tasked to C-UAS, WAFOR loses combat power elsewhere.</li><li>• If C-UAS is left solely to nations, coverage will be uneven and critical nodes may be exposed.</li><li>• JLSN nodes require assigned lead-nation protection, with layered EW, hard-kill, dispersion and overhead protection.</li><li>• Contributing nations must deploy with organic sub-unit C-UAS for their own troops, convoys and static positions.</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• <b>COMWAFOR must not</b> make rely on existing NATO C-UAS capability codes &amp; statements to solve the C-UAS threat.</li><li>• <b>COMWAFOR must</b> decide on C-UAS resourcing before deployment.</li><li>• <b>COMWAFOR must</b> mandate C-UAS for JLSN nodes and MSRs.</li><li>• <b>COMWAFOR must</b> consider land-movements within SIERRA LEONE as a critical vulnerability for C-UAS.</li><li>• <b>COMWAFOR should</b> designate a lead nation for JLSN node protection.</li><li>• Force generation must require national organic sub-unit hard-kill C-UAS as a contributing nation obligation.</li></ul> |



# COMPARISON (LDR)

Results from

- Viability test
- Risk assessment
- Wargame

| CIVIC SHIELD                                                                                                                                                  | CARBON CRUSH                                                                                                                                                                             |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Advantages:</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- Comprehensive</li><li>- Focus on long term success</li></ul>                                       | <b>Advantages:</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- Robust posture with same number of forces</li><li>- Deterrence</li><li>- Quickly directed towards the diamond mines</li></ul> |
| <b>Disadvantages:</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- Slower tempo</li><li>- Reactive posture</li><li>- Dependence on local/external actors</li></ul> | <b>Disadvantages:</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- More risk of escalation</li><li>- Kinetic actions insufficient to defeat insurgents</li></ul>                              |



# Compare Cdr's Selection Criteria (LDR)

| Criteria                 | CIVIC SHIELD    | CARBON CRUSH   |
|--------------------------|-----------------|----------------|
| Time/speed (x2)          | 1 (2)           | 2 (4)          |
| Risk (x2)                | 2 (4)           | 1 (2)          |
| Sustainability (x2)      | 1 (2)           | 1 (2)          |
| Comprehensiveness (x1,5) | 2 (3)           | 1 (1,5)        |
| Flexibility (x1,5)       | 1 (1,5)         | 3 (4,5)        |
| Simplicity (x1)          | 1 (1)           | 2 (2)          |
| <b>Totals</b>            | <b>8 (13,5)</b> | <b>10 (16)</b> |

**Recommended COA = CARBON CRUSH**





# CONCLUSIONS (LDR)



1. ACOAs: merged SL insurgents and LIBERIA into one threat
2. Operational design: minor changes
3. JOA/ROE: fit for purpose
4. Forces: need for non-organic C-UAS – additional FP (JLSG, SL training centres – additional MSU – extensive intelligence collection assets
5. Reserve forces expected to play an important role
6. SACEUR Strategic Reserve: 01 Infantry Bde, multirole fighters, 01 SOTG, NATO Expanded TF
7. SL insurgents likely difficult to defeat, but a LIBERIAN attack is both a risk and an opportunity
8. Important effort needed to uphold credibility of WAFOR
9. KLE likely necessary to keep GUI out of regional conflict
10. Friendly casualties cannot be prevented -> create awareness amongst TCN
11. Attacks will put sustainment under stress
12. Effectiveness of SL troops unsure



# COMMANDER'S D&G (LDR)



1. COA decision, including
  - *Decision on final operational design*
  - *Direction for COA or operational design revision*
  - *Refined Component Provisional Mission*
  - *Guidance to Planning Staff*
2. Confirmation of Commander's Intent
3. Planning Guidance for CONOPS Development